

MIRRORBLOOM

A World Split Like a Mirror

Compendium of Gods, Fey Lords, Courts, and Realms

Living Document — Updated as the World Grows

THE COSMOLOGY OF MIRRORBLOOM

Mirrorbloom is a single flat world, split top and bottom like a reflection on still water. The upper half is whimsical, beautiful, Alice-coded fantasy. The lower half is its exact dark mirror — pure horror. The Law of Reflection binds them: beauty and goodness generated above directly feeds horror and evil below.

Fifteen empires govern the upper half, each independent and sometimes rivalrous. Each has a direct evil twin empire below — same name, same people, corrupted.

Each empire is patron to one of the Six Great Fey Lords, who themselves were born from the Breaking: the moment two ancient, equal lovers — the Great Hope and the Great Despair — came apart, splitting the world in two. No one alive knows why they split; even in-world, it remains a mystery. The Great Hope does not know what became of the Great Despair, or what she now believes was taken from her. Only the Fey Lords know the full truth, and they have never told her.

Each of the twelve Fey Lord aspects (six Lords, each with a bright and shadow half) holds court — a structured nobility of five shared roles: Seneschal, Champion, Herald, Confessor, and Forsaken — and rules a realm of their own, tied closely to Mirrorbloom but standing outside it, reachable only through doorways. Some doorways are fixed and well-mapped; others wander, appearing and vanishing without warning. Through these doors, a Fey Lord may pull a being out into Mirrorbloom, or push a piece of their own realm into the world.



THE GREAT HOPE

She Who Does Not Know

Gargantuan fey, neutral good — Challenge 24

Before the Breaking, there was no Wonderland above and no Hollow Court below — there was only the Great Hope and the Great Despair, two halves of a single radiant whole, though no living thing remembers what that whole was called, or whether it had a name at all. Something happened between them. No record survives of what. The world split in the moment of their parting, and the Great Hope rose into the bright half, untouched by whatever grief caused the rupture, because she does not remember there was a rupture at all. She believes herself simply to be hope, entire and uncomplicated, and in a very real sense, she is right — the not-knowing is not a wound to her, only an absence shaped like one. She wanders the Unclouded and occasionally Wonderland itself, radiant and sincere, utterly unaware that somewhere beneath her, something that loved her now believes a crown was stolen from its head. The six Fey Lords, born from the Breaking itself, know the truth. None of them have ever told her.

THE GREAT HOPE

Gargantuan fey, neutral good — CR 30 (155,000 XP)

Armor Class 23 (natural armor)

Hit Points 585 (39d20 + 195)

Speed 30 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)	28 (+9)	30 (+10)

Saving Throws Con +13, Wis +17, Cha +18

Skills Insight +17, Persuasion +18, Medicine +17

Damage Resistances radiant, psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities fire, necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages all, telepathy 120 ft.

Radiant Field. The Great Hope radiates warmth. All creatures within 60 feet that she considers allies regain 15 hit points at the start of their turns. Hostile creatures that start their turn within 30 feet must make a DC 26 Constitution saving throw or be blinded until the start of their next turn.

Unbearable Sincerity. The Great Hope cannot lie and cannot be deceived. Any creature that attempts to lie to her must make a DC 26 Charisma saving throw or be compelled to speak truthfully for 1 minute. Additionally, all illusions within 60 feet of her are automatically dispelled.

She Who Does Not Know. The Great Hope is immune to effects that would reveal information about the Great Despair, the Breaking, or what the Fey Lords know. This is not resistance — the knowledge simply does not reach her. Any being that attempts to tell her directly must make a DC 28 Wisdom saving throw or find the words failing before they form.

Innate Spellcasting. The Great Hope's spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 26). She can cast the following spells innately, requiring no material components: At will: cure wounds (as 9th level), daylight, greater restoration. 3/day each: heal, mass cure wounds, sunbeam. 1/day each: true resurrection, wish (used only to restore or protect, never to harm).

Magic Resistance. The Great Hope has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Legendary Resistance (5/Day). If the Great Hope fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Light Endures. If the Great Hope is reduced to 0 hit points, she does not die. Instead she becomes incorporeal light for 1 minute, cannot be targeted or damaged, and at the end of that minute returns to 1 hit point. This ability recharges at dawn. While in light form, all creatures within 120 feet regain 30 hit points.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Great Hope makes three Radiant Touch attacks, or makes two Radiant Touch attacks and uses Compel Honesty once.

Radiant Touch. Melee Spell Attack: +18 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 36 (4d12 + 10) radiant damage. A creature reduced to 0 hit points by this attack is not killed — it falls unconscious, stable, and dreaming of something warm.

Wave of Dawn (Recharge 5-6). The Great Hope releases a 90-foot radius burst of golden light. Each hostile creature in the area must make a DC 26 Constitution saving throw, taking 88 (16d10) radiant damage on a failure or half on a success. All allied creatures in the area regain 44 (8d10) hit points.

Compel Honesty. The Great Hope fixes her gaze on one creature within 60 feet. The creature must make a DC 26 Charisma saving throw. On a failure, it can only speak truthfully for 1 hour and is incapacitated for 1 round as the sincerity arrives all at once.

Unbounded Grace (1/Day). The Great Hope extends absolute protection to all creatures within 120 feet that she considers allies. For 1 minute, those creatures cannot be reduced below 1 hit point by any means, are immune to all conditions, and regain 20 hit points at the start of each of their turns. Concentration is not required.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Great Hope can take 4 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The Great Hope regains spent legendary actions at the start of her turn.

Step of Light. The Great Hope moves up to her speed without provoking opportunity attacks. Each hostile creature she passes within 5 feet takes 14 (4d6) radiant damage.

Touch. The Great Hope makes one Radiant Touch attack.

A Brighter Day (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 60 feet that the Great Hope can see is restored: it regains 60 hit points, all conditions are removed, and it gains advantage on all saving throws until the end of its next turn.

The Meadow Opens (Costs 3 Actions). The Great Hope briefly pulls a patch of the Unclouded into the current location — a 30-foot radius of golden meadow appears around her for 1 round. All creatures in the area that she considers hostile must make a DC 26 Wisdom save or be incapacitated as they briefly experience perfect, unbearable peace. All allies in the area are healed for 40 hit points.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), the Great Hope can take a lair action to cause one of the following effects in the Unclouded:

Meadow Breaks Through. The ground in a 60-foot radius around the Great Hope becomes Unclouded meadow — golden, warm, and difficult terrain for hostile creatures (DC 20 Strength save or be restrained for 1 round by flowering vines).

Golden Hour. All creatures within 120 feet that the Great Hope considers allies regain 30 hit points and are freed from any condition.

Echo of What Was Lost. One creature within 120 feet that the Great Hope targets must make a DC 26 Wisdom save or spend its next turn moving toward her, compelled by a memory of warmth they cannot name.



THE GREAT DESPAIR

The Uncrowned Queen

Gargantuan fey, lawful evil — Challenge 24

She remembers the Breaking, or believes she does, which amounts to the same agony either way. In her telling — and it is the only telling the Hollow Court is permitted to repeat — a crown was taken from her in the moment of the world's splitting, a right, a throne, something owed that was stripped away by forces she can no longer name. She has spent every year since trying to reclaim it. There is no crown. There was never a crown. What she actually lost was the Great Hope herself, and somewhere beneath the six glowing eyes and the razor smile, a part of her may even understand this — which is precisely why the lie has to be so carefully, so violently maintained. She wears a twisted mockery of regalia, dresses for a war she's still fighting, and rules the Hollow Court not as a monarch enthroned but as a general still marching toward a victory that was never the actual goal.

THE GREAT DESPAIR

Gargantuan fey, lawful evil — CR 30 (155,000 XP)

Armor Class 22 (natural armor); see Crowned in Ruin

Hit Points 620 (48d20 + 144)

Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft. (can move along walls and ceilings)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	24 (+7)	22 (+6)	28 (+9)

Saving Throws Con +10, Int +15, Wis +13, Cha +17

Skills Arcana +15, Deception +17, Insight +13, Intimidation +17, Perception +13

Damage Resistances necrotic, psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities cold, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages all, telepathy 120 ft.

Despair Feeds. Whenever a creature within 60 feet of the Great Despair fails a saving throw or is reduced to 0 hit points, the Great Despair regains 20 hit points. This cannot raise her above her maximum.

Crowned in Ruin. The Great Despair believes absolutely in a crown that was never real. While she believes this (always, unless somehow magically convinced otherwise, which has never happened), she has advantage on all saving throws and her AC cannot be reduced below 18 by any effect.

The Lie of the Crown. Any creature that willingly listens to the Great Despair speak for 1 minute must make a DC 26 Wisdom saving throw or become convinced of one false thing of her choosing for 24 hours. The false thing always relates to something being owed, stolen, or rightfully theirs. A creature that succeeds is immune to this effect for 24 hours.

Innate Spellcasting. The Great Despair's spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 26). At will: bane, bestow curse, darkness, fear. 3/day each: dominate monster, feebleshield, power word stun. 1/day each: power word kill, wish (used only to take, never to give).

Magic Resistance. The Great Despair has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Legendary Resistance (5/Day). If the Great Despair fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Crown Must Be Reclaimed. If the Great Despair is reduced to 0 hit points, she immediately makes a DC 20 Charisma saving throw. On a success, she returns to 100 hit points, her six eyes open fully, and she enters a state of absolute certainty for 1 minute — she has advantage on all attacks and saving throws, and her damage rolls deal maximum damage. This ability recharges only on a short or long rest.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Great Despair makes three attacks: two with Claws of the Forgotten Queen and one with Devouring Maw, or uses Whisper of the Crown twice and makes one Claw attack.

Devouring Maw. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 44 (6d12 + 8) piercing damage plus 22 (4d10) necrotic damage. The target's maximum hit points are reduced by the necrotic damage dealt until it finishes a long rest.

Claws of the Forgotten Queen. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 30 (4d10 + 8) slashing damage. On a hit, the target must make a DC 26 Wisdom save or be frightened of the Great Despair for 1 minute.

Gaze of Six Sorrows (Recharge 5-6). The Great Despair opens all six of her eyes and fixes them on every creature in a 90-foot cone. Each creature must make a DC 26 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the creature takes 88 (16d10) psychic damage, drops whatever it is holding, and is stunned until the end of its next turn. On a success, the creature takes half damage and is not stunned.

Whisper of the Crown. The Great Despair whispers to one creature within 120 feet that can hear her. The creature must make a DC 26 Wisdom saving throw or take 35 (10d6) psychic damage and believe, until the end of its next turn, that something valuable has been stolen from it — it must use its next action to retrieve or attack the nearest creature, targeting its closest ally if no enemy is adjacent.

The Hollow Court Descends (1/Day). The Great Despair summons the weight of her entire court. Each creature within 120 feet that she considers hostile must make a DC 26 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, the creature takes 110 (20d10) necrotic damage and gains 3 levels of exhaustion. On a success, the creature takes half damage and gains 1 level of exhaustion. The Great Despair regains 50 hit points for each creature that fails this save.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Great Despair can take 4 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn.

Step Through Shadow. The Great Despair teleports up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space she can see, leaving a patch of absolute darkness at her origin point that lasts until the start of her next turn.

Claw. The Great Despair makes one Claws of the Forgotten Queen attack.

Feed the Crown (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 60 feet must make a DC 26 Charisma saving throw or have its maximum hit points reduced by 30 until it finishes a long rest, as the Great Despair takes something from it she will claim was always hers. She regains hit points equal to the amount taken.

All Six Eyes (Costs 3 Actions). The Great Despair fixes her complete attention on one creature within 120 feet. That creature must immediately make a DC 26 Wisdom save or drop to 0 hit points as six simultaneous gazes of absolute grief overwhelm it. On a success, the creature takes 55 (10d10) psychic damage.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), the Great Despair can take a lair action to cause one of the following effects in the Hollow Court:

The Weight of the Crown. All creatures within 60 feet that the Great Despair considers hostile must make a DC 26 Strength saving throw or be restrained for 1 round, pressed down by invisible weight.

Despair Spreads. Each creature of the Great Despair's choice within 120 feet must make a DC 26 Wisdom saving throw or take 28 (8d6) psychic damage and have disadvantage on attack rolls until the start of the next initiative count 20.

The Court Remembers. One creature within 120 feet is confronted by the memory of its greatest failure. It must make a DC 26 Wisdom saving throw or be incapacitated until the start of the next initiative count 20 and take 35 (10d6) psychic damage.



THE DAWNWARD KING

First Light

Huge archfey, chaotic good — Challenge 15

Born in the instant the Breaking occurred — the very first moment of the new, split world — the Dawnward King has lived every day since as though it were that same first moment, because to him, it always is. He retains no memory from one sunrise to the next; the Unworn Throne is attended each morning by a court he is meeting, as far as he knows, for the very first time, regardless of how many centuries they've actually served him. This is not cruelty and not tragedy, exactly — the Dawnward King is, by every account, profoundly and consistently joyful, incapable of holding a grudge, a wound, or a plan for longer than a single day allows. His shadow, the Duskward King, carries the memory he cannot, and the two have never spoken, as far as anyone can determine, in all the time since the Breaking.

THE DAWNWARD KING

Huge archfey, chaotic good — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points 385 (30d12 + 180)

Speed 40 ft., fly 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)

Saving Throws Str +14, Con +14, Wis +13, Cha +14

Skills Perception +13, Athletics +14

Damage Resistances radiant; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities fire, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages Sylvan, Common, telepathy 60 ft.

First Light, Unremembered. The Dawnward King has no memory of previous encounters. He cannot be surprised, cannot learn exploits from prior fights, and cannot be demoralized by past victories over him. Every combat is, to him, literally his first.

No Yesterday. The Dawnward King is immune to effects that reference his past actions — he cannot be hit by readied actions triggered by his previous turn's movement, cannot be targeted by spells that require memory of him, and cannot be the subject of prediction magic.

Every Day, Anew. At the start of each of his turns, the Dawnward King removes one condition affecting him as the new day begins again.

Borrowed Morning. Creatures that deal damage to the Dawnward King must make a DC 22 Wisdom saving throw or forget which attacks they have already tried this combat, losing the benefit of advantage on their next attack roll.

Innate Spellcasting. Charisma-based (spell save DC 22). At will: daylight, faerie fire. 3/day: sunbeam. 1/day: sunburst.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Dawnward King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The First Morning Never Ends. When the Dawnward King is reduced to 0 hit points, roll a d6. On a 4-6, he rises at the start of his next turn with 80 hit points — he has forgotten he was dying.

ACTIONS

On his turn, roll 1d4 (or the DM secretly chooses) to determine which of the following the Dawnward King uses; see Every Day, Anew.

Multiattack. The Dawnward King makes three Radiant Greatblade attacks.

Radiant Greatblade. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 28 (4d10 + 6) radiant damage plus 14 (4d6) fire damage.

Sudden Sunrise. The Dawnward King raises his blade and light erupts in a 60-foot radius. Each creature of his choice in the area must make a DC 22 Constitution saving throw or be blinded until the end of its next turn and take 35 (10d6) radiant damage. On a success, half damage and not blinded.

The First Morning Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The First Morning realm pushes into the current location. A 90-foot radius fills with the quality of the very first dawn — everything too bright, too new. All hostile creatures make DC 22 Wisdom save or be incapacitated for 1 round, overwhelmed by the specific vertigo of a morning that has never happened before. The Dawnward King regains 40 hit points.

Wandering Step. The Dawnward King teleports up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space he can see as a bonus action. He does not remember where he teleported from.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Dawnward King can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below.

Bright Step. The Dawnward King moves up to his speed. Each creature within 5 feet of the path takes 14 (4d6) radiant damage.

Flash of Now. The Dawnward King makes one Radiant Greatblade attack with advantage — he has never seen this enemy before and the freshness gives him an edge.

Reroll the Day (Costs 2 Actions). The Dawnward King resets his position to where he started his last turn and regains 40 hit points, as he briefly returns to the beginning of the moment.

Rise Again (Costs 3 Actions). The Dawnward King removes all conditions and regains 60 hit points. A new dawn breaks locally — all creatures within 30 feet take 21 (6d6) radiant damage (DC 22 Dexterity save for half).

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Dawnward King can take a lair action in the First Morning:

New Light. A burst of first-dawn light fills a 30-foot radius. Hostile creatures make DC 22 Con save or be blinded for 1 round.

The Day Begins. One hostile creature loses all benefits from actions taken before this moment in the combat — advantage granted by prior positioning is lost, ongoing effects from previous turns end.

Endless Morning. The Dawnward King and all allies regain 25 hit points as the morning genuinely seems to begin again.



THE DUSKWARD KING

Last Light

Huge archfey, neutral evil — Challenge 15

He remembers everything. Every ending, every failure, every quiet defeat that has ever occurred since the Breaking split him free of his brighter twin — all of it remains with him, perfectly preserved, growing heavier with each passing year. The Throne of Ash is less a seat of power than a place where endings come to rest, and the Duskward King receives them all without complaint, because complaint would require believing things could have gone differently, and he has the memory to prove, definitively, in case after case, that they did not. His court — bound to him not by choice but by the simple, terrible fact of having failed greatly enough to be remembered — has slowly learned to find a strange comfort in being witnessed so completely, even by something this sorrowful.

THE DUSKWARD KING

Huge archfey, neutral evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 21 (natural armor)

Hit Points 400 (32d12 + 192)

Speed 30 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	22 (+6)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Con +14, Int +12, Wis +13, Cha +12

Skills History +12, Insight +13, Perception +13

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities cold, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages all, telepathy 60 ft.

Nothing Forgotten. The Duskward King remembers every action taken against him in this combat. The first time each combat that a creature uses a specific attack or ability against him, he gains resistance to that damage type for the rest of the encounter.

The Broken Horn. The Duskward King's memory of the Breaking is perfect. He cannot be affected by mind-altering spells of 7th level or lower and has immunity to the charmed condition.

Tireless Pursuer. The Duskward King cannot be exhausted by movement. His speed cannot be reduced below 20 feet by any magical effect.

The Last Evening Gathers. Creatures that die within 60 feet of the Duskward King are recorded — he knows their name, the cause of death, and exactly how they fell. He can use this knowledge to grant disadvantage on saves for creatures mourning those deaths (DM's discretion).

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 22). At will: darkness, silence. 3/day: hold monster. 1/day: power word stun.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Duskward King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Last Evening Never Ends. When the Duskward King is reduced to 0 hit points, he does not immediately fall — he takes one final legendary action for free before collapsing.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Duskward King makes three Entropy Strike attacks.

Entropy Strike. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 30 (4d12 + 6) necrotic damage. The target's maximum hit points are reduced by 10 until it finishes a long rest.

Weight of All Endings (Recharge 5-6). One creature within 90 feet must make a DC 22 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure: 88 (16d10) psychic damage and the creature is stunned until the end of its next turn. On a success: half damage. If this reduces a creature to 0 hit points, its maximum hit points are permanently reduced by 20 (restored by greater restoration).

The Last Evening Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Last Evening pushes into the location. A 90-foot radius fills with deep purple twilight — no light source brighter than a candle functions, and all creatures that can see must make DC 22 Wisdom save or have disadvantage on attack rolls for 1 minute as everything looks like it is already ending.

Record the Moment. The Duskward King freezes one moment in a 30-foot radius. All creatures in the area make DC 22 Constitution save or be paralyzed for 1 round, caught in amber as the last evening preserves them.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Duskward King can take 3 legendary actions.

Dark Step. The Duskward King moves up to his speed through magical darkness without penalty.

Entropy. The Duskward King makes one Entropy Strike attack.

What Has Already Ended (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 60 feet takes 35 (10d6) necrotic damage (DC 22 Con save for half) and is aged 1d10 years (cosmetic, but DM may apply disadvantage on Athletics checks).

The Record is Final (Costs 3 Actions). The Duskward King declares that one creature within 60 feet has reached its ending. That creature makes DC 22 Charisma save or drop to 0 hit points. On a success: 70 (20d6) necrotic damage instead.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Duskward King can take a lair action in the Last Evening:

Twilight Falls. All light sources within 120 feet are reduced to dim light for 1 round.

Weight of Memory. One creature within 120 feet relives its worst memory and takes 35 (10d6) psychic damage (DC 22 Wis save for half).

The Evening Remembers. The Duskward King regains 30 hit points and knows the exact HP of every creature in his lair.



THE VERDANT LADY

The Garden Unbroken

Large archfey, neutral good — Challenge 15

Of the six Fey Lords born from the Breaking, the Verdant Lady is, by wide consensus, the gentlest, and the Greenbower she tends is the closest thing Wonderland has to a place entirely without cruelty. She is growth itself, made patient and deliberate — not wild, exactly, despite her domain, but tended, the way a garden is wild only within careful boundaries a gardener has chosen. She asks nothing of her visitors beyond genuine care in return for genuine abundance. It is worth noting, and rarely said aloud, that her gentleness is not innocence — the Verdant Lady knows exactly what her own goodness costs the world below her, and tends her garden anyway, because the alternative, in her own words, helps no one and grows nothing.

THE VERDANT LADY

Large archfey, neutral good — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points 370 (28d10 + 168)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	24 (+7)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Con +14, Wis +15, Cha +12

Skills Nature +12, Perception +15, Survival +15

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., tremorsense 120 ft., passive Perception 25

Languages Sylvan, Common, telepathy 60 ft. with plants

The Garden Unbroken. The Verdant Lady cannot be moved against her will while in contact with natural ground. Any forced movement effect fails. Her speed cannot be reduced below 20 feet.

Living World. The Verdant Lady is aware of all creatures in contact with natural ground within 300 feet of her. She cannot be surprised while outdoors or in natural terrain.

What Growth Becomes. Any creature that takes poison damage from the Verdant Lady must make a DC 22 Constitution saving throw or become Rooted — their speed is reduced to 0 and they cannot take the Dash action for 1 minute (repeated saves at end of each turn).

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 23). At will: entangle, speak with plants. 3/day: plant growth, wall of thorns. 1/day: storm of vengeance.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Verdant Lady fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Garden Returns. If the Verdant Lady is reduced to 0 hit points while in natural terrain, she merges with the ground and reforms at the start of her next turn with 80 hit points in an unoccupied space within 60 feet. This functions once per combat.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Verdant Lady makes three Thornlash attacks or two Thornlash attacks and one Rooting Grasp.

Thornlash. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 20 ft., one target. Hit: 29 (4d10 + 7) piercing damage plus 18 (4d8) poison damage.

Rooting Grasp. One creature within 30 feet must make a DC 23 Strength saving throw or be Rooted (speed 0, cannot Dash) and take 35 (10d6) piercing damage from thorns erupting beneath them. A Rooted creature takes 18 (4d8) piercing damage at the start of each of its turns.

The Greenbower Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Greenbower realm floods into the location — a 120-foot radius of dense, ancient forest appears instantly. All hostile creatures in the area make DC 23 Strength save or be Rooted and take 44 (8d10) piercing damage. The area becomes difficult terrain and the Verdant Lady has total cover while within it.

Call the Forest. The Verdant Lady calls on natural creatures. She summons 1d4 treants (CR 9) or 2d6 dryads (CR 1) that appear in unoccupied spaces within 60 feet and act on her initiative count.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Verdant Lady can take 3 legendary actions.

Root Step. The Verdant Lady moves up to her speed. She does not provoke opportunity attacks and leaves a trail of difficult terrain.

Thornlash. The Verdant Lady makes one Thornlash attack.

The Garden Defends (Costs 2 Actions). Thorns erupt around one creature within 60 feet. It makes DC 23 Dex save or take 35 (10d6) piercing damage and be Rooted.

Ancient Growth (Costs 3 Actions). The Verdant Lady heals 80 hit points and all Rooted creatures take 44 (8d10) piercing damage as the thorns tighten.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Verdant Lady can take a lair action in the Greenbower:

The Garden Grows. A 30-foot radius of the area becomes dense undergrowth (difficult terrain, blocks line of sight for creatures without truesight).

Bloom and Wither. All Rooted creatures take 28 (8d6) poison damage automatically.

Living Wall. A wall of living wood and thorns 60 feet long, 10 feet high, 5 feet thick erupts from the ground. It has AC 14 and 100 hit points.



THE BLOATED LADY

What Growth Becomes

Large archfey, neutral evil — Challenge 15

Nature that never learned restraint, the Bloated Lady is not malicious so much as endlessly, mindlessly hungry — growth without a gardener's hand to stop it, abundance curdled into consumption. She does not hunt deliberately the way some of her siblings do; she simply does not stop, and anything that lingers too long within reach of the Drowned Garden eventually becomes part of it, slowly, without any single decisive moment marking the change. The Rootless, her court, are less subjects than they are unfinished transformations, each one a body the swamp hasn't quite finished claiming. She is the purest expression of the Law of Reflection's cruelty: the Verdant Lady's careful goodness above becomes, below, a hunger with no off switch at all.

THE BLOATED LADY

Large archfey, neutral evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)

Hit Points 420 (35d10 + 245)

Speed 20 ft., swim 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
24 (+7)	10 (+0)	24 (+7)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +15, Con +15, Wis +12

Skills Nature +11, Perception +12

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 22

Languages Sylvan, Common

What Growth Becomes. Bloom Sickness: creatures that fail saves against the Bloated Lady's abilities gain a level of Bloom Sickness. At 3 stacks: disadvantage on Constitution saves. At 5 stacks: poisoned condition. At 7 stacks: the creature begins transforming — it gains the plant type as a secondary type and the Bloated Lady can issue it one command per turn (DC 22 Wisdom save to resist).

The Garden Overflows. Whenever a creature within 60 feet regains hit points, the Bloated Lady regains half that amount as the overflow feeds her.

Innate Spellcasting. Constitution-based (spell save DC 23). At will: entangle, poison spray. 3/day: cloudkill, contagion. 1/day: power word stun.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Bloated Lady fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Too Much. When the Bloated Lady is reduced to half her hit points, she explodes outward in a burst of toxic growth — all creatures within 30 feet take 44 (8d10) poison damage (DC 23 Con save for half) and gain 2 levels of Bloom Sickness.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Bloated Lady makes three Consuming Slam attacks.

Consuming Slam. Melee Weapon Attack: +15 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 32 (4d12 + 6) bludgeoning plus 22 (4d10) poison damage. Target makes DC 23 Con save or gains 2 levels of Bloom Sickness.

Engulf (Recharge 5-6). Each creature in a 20-foot radius must make a DC 23 Dexterity saving throw or be restrained and take 55 (10d10) poison damage, gaining 3 levels of Bloom Sickness. Restrained creatures repeat the save at the end of each turn, taking 28 (8d6) poison damage on a failure.

The Drowned Garden Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Drowned Garden floods into the location. A 120-foot radius fills with fetid, nutrient-rich water to knee depth. All creatures in the area make DC 23 Constitution save or gain 2 levels of Bloom Sickness and have their speed halved. The Bloated Lady's speed doubles while the garden is present (1 minute).

Feed. The Bloated Lady targets one Bloom-Sick creature within 60 feet. That creature makes DC 23 Constitution save or have its Bloom Sickness level increased by 3. The Bloated Lady regains 30 hit points.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Bloated Lady can take 3 legendary actions.

Overgrowth Step. The Bloated Lady moves up to her speed. Each creature she passes within 5 feet makes DC 23 Con save or gains 1 level of Bloom Sickness.

Slam. The Bloated Lady makes one Consuming Slam attack.

Bloom (Costs 2 Actions). All Bloom-Sick creatures within 60 feet take 28 (8d6) poison damage automatically.

Full Bloom (Costs 3 Actions). All creatures within 60 feet make DC 23 Con save or gain 2 levels of Bloom Sickness and take 35 (10d6) poison damage.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Bloated Lady can take a lair action in the Drowned Garden:

The Garden Drinks. All Bloom-Sick creatures within 120 feet lose 10 maximum hit points until they finish a long rest.

Spore Cloud. A 30-foot radius cloud of spores erupts. Creatures in the area make DC 23 Con save or gain 1 level of Bloom Sickness.

Growth Surge. The Bloated Lady regains 40 hit points and all Bloom Sickness levels in her lair increase by 1.



THE JESTER KING

A Thousand Faces, Each One Borrowed

Medium archfey, chaotic neutral — Challenge 15

No one has ever seen the Jester King's true face, including, it's whispered, the Jester King himself. He wears a new mask to every audience, every duel, every performance, each one beautiful, each one a deliberate choice rather than a deception meant to wound — his court, the Punchline, plays a strange and constant game of riddles and wit that occasionally tips, without warning, into genuine prophecy. He is chaotic but never cruel by intention; the harm he occasionally causes tends to be collateral, the unavoidable cost of a joke landing exactly where it needed to in order to be true.

THE JESTER KING

Medium archfey, chaotic neutral — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 21 (mage armor; see Worn Faces)

Hit Points 330 (36d8 + 144)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	24 (+7)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	26 (+8)

Saving Throws Dex +15, Int +14, Cha +16

Skills Acrobatics +15, Deception +16, Performance +16, Sleight of Hand +15

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages all, telepathy 60 ft.

Worn Faces. The Jester King wears every face simultaneously. He cannot be identified by divination magic. Truesight sees a different face each time it is used. His AC cannot be reduced and he cannot be targeted by effects that require knowing his true name or nature.

A Thousand Faces, Each One Borrowed. As a bonus action, the Jester King can take the exact appearance of any creature he has seen. He perfectly replicates their voice, mannerisms, and surface magical signature. Only a DC 25 Insight check reveals the impersonation, and even on a success the observer is not certain.

Punchline. Whenever a creature fails a saving throw against one of the Jester King's abilities, it gains a Setup Stack (max 5). Once a creature has 3+ stacks, the Jester King can spend all of them as a bonus action to trigger the Punchline: the creature takes 14 (4d6) psychic damage per stack spent and is incapacitated until the end of its next turn.

Innate Spellcasting. Charisma-based (spell save DC 24). At will: disguise self, major image, Tasha's hideous laughter. 3/day: mass suggestion, seeming. 1/day: weird.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Jester King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Show Must Go On. When the Jester King is reduced to 0 hit points, he makes a DC 20 Charisma saving throw. On a success, the 'death' is revealed to be a performance — he was never really there — and he reappears with 60 hit points in an unoccupied space within 120 feet. This works once per combat.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Jester King makes three attacks with his Jestling Blade and applies Setup Stacks on each hit.

Jestling Blade. Melee Weapon Attack: +15 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 28 (4d10 + 6) slashing plus 22 (4d10) psychic damage. Applies 1 Setup Stack.

Grand Reveal (Recharge 5-6). The Jester King drops all his masks simultaneously. Every creature within 60 feet that can see him must make a DC 24 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure: 66 (12d10) psychic damage, stunned until end of next turn, and gains 2 Setup Stacks. On a success: half damage, not stunned.

The Masquerade Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Masquerade floods into the current location. For 1 minute, all creatures except the Jester King and his allies have their appearances randomized — each looks like a different creature (rolled randomly). They cannot be identified by sight. Spells that require targeting a specific creature must make a DC 24 Intelligence check to target correctly.

Stand-In. The Jester King creates a perfect duplicate of himself in an unoccupied space within 30 feet. The duplicate has 60 hit points, the same AC, and on its turn makes one Jestling Blade attack. It is destroyed if it takes any damage or at the end of the Jester King's next turn.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Jester King can take 3 legendary actions.

Quick Change. The Jester King teleports up to 60 feet and changes appearance as a free action.

Jesting Blade. The Jester King makes one Jesting Blade attack and applies 1 Setup Stack.

Punchline Early (Costs 2 Actions). The Jester King triggers the Punchline on any creature with 2+ Setup Stacks within 120 feet.

Everyone's Laughing (Costs 3 Actions). All creatures within 60 feet make DC 24 Wisdom save or be affected by Tasha's hideous laughter for 1 minute and gain 2 Setup Stacks.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Jester King can take a lair action in the Masquerade:

Mirror Hall. All creatures in the lair see a random creature instead of their actual allies for 1 round — they must make DC 22 Intelligence check to identify each creature correctly before targeting it.

Punchline Storm. Every creature with at least 1 Setup Stack takes 14 (4d6) psychic damage per stack automatically.

The Show Continues. The Jester King and all allies regain 30 hit points and remove one condition each.



THE MOCKING KING

The Smile That Cannot Move

Medium archfey, chaotic evil — Challenge 15

His mask is not chosen. It is taken — stitched, fused, made permanent through means his court understands and does not discuss — and once worn, the Mocking King's borrowed face never changes expression again, regardless of what occurs beneath it. Where his bright twin's wit can tip accidentally into cruelty, the Mocking King's cruelty is the entire performance: the Last Laugh exists to torment with exquisite comedic timing, building toward a punishment delivered with exactly the cadence of a joke's punchline.

THE MOCKING KING

Medium archfey, chaotic evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points 360 (32d10 + 192)

Speed 40 ft.

STR
20 (+5)

DEX
20 (+5)

CON
22 (+6)

INT
20 (+5)

WIS
18 (+4)

CHA
24 (+7)

Saving Throws Dex +13, Con +14, Cha +15

Skills Deception +15, Intimidation +15, Perception +12

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 22

Languages all, telepathy 60 ft.

The Smile That Cannot Move. The Mocking King's face does not change. It is fixed in an expression of absolute amusement. Creatures that attempt to read his emotions or intentions automatically fail — Insight checks against him have no result. He is immune to effects that read thoughts or detect emotional states.

Setup and Punchline. Whenever a creature fails a saving throw against one of the Mocking King's abilities, it gains a Setup Stack (max 6). When a creature accumulates 3+ stacks, the Mocking King can spend all of them as a bonus action: the creature takes 18 (4d8) psychic damage per stack spent and is stunned until the end of its next turn.

The Audience. All creatures within 120 feet of the Mocking King that can see or hear him must make a DC 23 Wisdom save at the start of each of their turns or have disadvantage on their first attack roll that turn — they are performing, and performance makes you self-conscious.

Innate Spellcasting. Charisma-based (spell save DC 23). At will: vicious mockery (as 5th level: 6d4), bane. 3/day: mass suggestion, fear. 1/day: power word stun.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Mocking King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Last Laugh. When the Mocking King is reduced to 0 hit points, he laughs. All creatures within 60 feet must make a DC 23 Wisdom save or take 55 (10d10) psychic damage and be frightened for 1 minute. He then dies, still smiling.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Mocking King makes three Mocking Strike attacks. Each hit applies 1 Setup Stack.

Mocking Strike. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 30 (4d10 + 8) slashing plus 22 (4d10) psychic damage. Applies 1 Setup Stack.

The Cruellest Joke (Recharge 5-6). The Mocking King addresses one creature within 120 feet with a perfectly crafted description of its greatest failure. That creature makes DC 23 Wisdom save. On failure: 88 (16d10) psychic damage, stunned until end of next turn, and gains 3 Setup Stacks. On success: half damage.

The Shattered Masquerade Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Shattered Masquerade floods in. A 120-foot radius fills with broken mirror pieces and distorted reflections. All hostile creatures make DC 23 Wisdom save or take 44 (8d10) psychic damage and see only cruel parodies of themselves in the reflections — disadvantage on all ability checks and saves for 1 minute.

Terrible Imitation. The Mocking King perfectly imitates one creature within 60 feet. That creature makes DC 23 Wisdom save or be incapacitated for 1 round, unable to process watching a perfect cruel copy of itself.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Mocking King can take 3 legendary actions.

Sidestep. The Mocking King moves up to his speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Strike. The Mocking King makes one Mocking Strike.

Punchline (Costs 2 Actions). Triggers the Setup/Punchline on any creature with 2+ stacks within 120 feet.

Bring the House Down (Costs 3 Actions). Every hostile creature within 60 feet makes DC 23 Wisdom save or take 35 (10d6) psychic damage and gain 2 Setup Stacks.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Mocking King can take a lair action in the Shattered Masquerade:

Broken Reflection. One creature within 120 feet sees a distorted reflection of itself. DC 23 Wisdom save or be incapacitated for 1 round.

Punchline Echo. All Setup Stacks on all creatures within 120 feet increase by 1.

The Audience Turns. The Mocking King and all allies regain 25 hit points and remove one condition.



THE LADY OF DREAMING

The Shape Sleep Takes

Large archfey, chaotic neutral — Challenge 15

She is barely a person at all, even by the standards of the Fey Lords — a drift of starlight and color where a body should be, experienced more than seen, known through dreams rather than direct encounter. The Lady of Dreaming governs sleep and imagination across all of Wonderland, and her presence in a sleeping mind is gentle almost without exception; nightmares, properly speaking, belong to her shadow twin, not to her. She is, perhaps, the Fey Lord least concerned with Wonderland's politics, the Law of Reflection, or anything beyond the immediate, soft, half-formed moment she happens to currently be.

THE LADY OF DREAMING

Large archfey, chaotic neutral — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 19 (see Half-Formed)

Hit Points 310 (36d10 + 108)

Speed 0 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	22 (+6)	16 (+3)	24 (+7)	26 (+8)	22 (+6)

Saving Throws Dex +15, Int +15, Wis +17, Cha +14

Skills Arcana +15, Insight +17, Perception +17

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 27

Languages all, telepathy 120 ft.

Half-Formed. The Lady of Dreaming exists partially in the dream layer. She has a 50% chance (roll a d6: 1-3) of being missed by any attack — the attack passes through her dream-half. If missed this way, the attacker sees themselves succeed before realizing they didn't.

The Shape Sleep Takes. Any creature that falls asleep within 300 feet of the Lady of Dreaming enters her dream layer and is aware of her presence there. She can communicate with sleeping creatures at any range without limit.

Dream Weaving. The Lady of Dreaming can alter the perceptions of any non-immune creature within 120 feet as a bonus action: she imposes or removes one sensory experience (sound, sight, smell) without a saving throw. This creates no damage and requires no concentration.

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 25). At will: hypnotic pattern, sleep (8th level: affects any total HP). 3/day: dream, modify memory. 1/day: psychic scream, wish (dream-related only).

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Lady of Dreaming fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Dream Persists. When the Lady of Dreaming is reduced to 0 hit points, she retreats entirely into the dream layer for 1 minute — invisible, intangible, unable to be targeted. At the end of that minute, she reforms with 80 hit points. This functions once per combat.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Lady of Dreaming makes three Dreamthread attacks.

Dreamthread. Melee Spell Attack: +15 to hit, reach 30 ft. (the thread extends through dream-space), one target. Hit: 28 (4d10 + 6) psychic damage. The target must make DC 25 Wisdom save or fall asleep for 1 round (awakened by damage).

Nightmare (Recharge 5-6). The Lady of Dreaming sends a specific nightmare into every creature of her choice within 120 feet that can see her. Each must make DC 25 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure: 88 (16d10) psychic damage and frightened for 1 minute. On a success: half damage. The nightmare is personalized — the Lady of Dreaming knows each creature's specific fear.

The Deep Dream Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Deep Dream floods in. A 120-foot radius fills with dream-logic — distances are wrong, gravity optional, and every creature that is not the Lady of Dreaming or her allies must make DC 25 Intelligence saving throw or be confused (as the confusion spell) for 1 minute.

Wake You Never (1/Day). The Lady of Dreaming touches one sleeping creature within 10 feet. That creature makes DC 25 Wisdom save or fall into a dreamless sleep from which it cannot be awakened by any means short of greater restoration or wish. The creature does not age or deteriorate. The Lady of Dreaming can maintain up to 5 creatures this way.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Lady of Dreaming can take 3 legendary actions.

Dream Step. The Lady of Dreaming moves through dream-space, teleporting up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space.

Dreamthread. The Lady of Dreaming makes one Dreamthread attack.

Sleep (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 60 feet makes DC 25 Wisdom save or falls asleep for 1 minute (awakened by damage).

The Dream Turns (Costs 3 Actions). All sleeping creatures within 120 feet immediately have their most comforting dream become their worst nightmare — they take 55 (10d10) psychic damage and wake screaming, frightened for 1 minute.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Lady of Dreaming can take a lair action in the Deep Dream:

Dream Logic. One hostile creature within 120 feet must make DC 25 Intelligence save or move in a random direction instead of its intended direction for 1 round.

Unending Sleep. All sleeping creatures within 120 feet take 28 (8d6) psychic damage without waking.

The Dream Heals. The Lady of Dreaming and all allies regain 30 hit points and remove one condition.



THE LADY OF WAKING

The Eyes That Will Not Close

Medium archfey, chaotic evil — Challenge 15

Every eye she has — and she has many, scattered without symmetry or apparent reason across her face and throat — stays open always, and she has made certain, in her domain, that yours will too. The Lady of Waking governs the horror of sleeplessness, the specific cruelty of a mind that cannot rest, and her court are bound to her not through any single dramatic act but through simple, accumulating exhaustion. She is patient in a way her bright twin could never manage to be, because she has nothing but time.

THE LADY OF WAKING

Medium archfey, chaotic evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 20 (natural armor)

Hit Points 350 (35d8 + 175)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)	26 (+8)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +13, Con +13, Int +14, Wis +17

Skills Insight +17, Investigation +14, Perception +17

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned, unconscious

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 27

Languages all

The Eyes Will Not Close. The Lady of Waking cannot be blinded by any means and sees through all illusions automatically. She has truesight to 120 feet and can see into the Ethereal Plane.

Cannot Look Away. Any creature within 60 feet of the Lady of Waking that does not attack her on its turn must make DC 23 Wisdom saving throw or take 22 (4d10) psychic damage as her attention creates unbearable pressure.

Perfect Wakefulness. The Lady of Waking cannot be surprised, cannot be put to sleep by any means, and cannot be paralyzed. She immediately perceives any lie within 120 feet of her.

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 25). At will: detect thoughts, true seeing. 3/day: hold monster, scrying. 1/day: psychic scream, foresight.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Lady of Waking fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Always Watching. The Lady of Waking is aware of every action taken within 300 feet of her. She cannot be flanked, and creatures cannot gain advantage on attacks against her through conventional means (positioning, feints). Only magical means can grant advantage on attacks against her.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Lady of Waking makes three Exhausting Strike attacks.

Exhausting Strike. Melee Spell Attack: +13 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 30 (4d12 + 4) psychic damage. Target makes DC 25 Constitution save or gain 1 level of exhaustion.

The Full Attention (Recharge 5-6). The Lady of Waking focuses completely on every hostile creature within 60 feet. Each must make DC 25 Wisdom saving throw. On failure: 88 (16d10) psychic damage, 2 levels of exhaustion, and disadvantage on all rolls for 1 minute. On success: half damage, 1 level of exhaustion.

The Unblinking Room Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Unblinking Room floods in. A 120-foot radius becomes a place of total surveillance — no creature can hide, become invisible, or use Stealth for 1 minute. All creatures make DC 25 Wisdom save or gain 1 level of exhaustion from being watched.

Waking Nightmare (1/Day). The Lady of Waking forces one creature within 120 feet to experience perfect, unblinking wakefulness. The creature makes DC 25 Constitution save or gain 4 levels of exhaustion instantly as decades of sleeplessness arrive at once. On success: 2 levels of exhaustion.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Lady of Waking can take 3 legendary actions.

Watchful Step. The Lady of Waking moves up to her speed. She does not provoke opportunity attacks.

Strike. The Lady of Waking makes one Exhausting Strike.

The Gaze (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 120 feet makes DC 25 Wis save or gain 2 levels of exhaustion.

You Cannot Rest (Costs 3 Actions). All hostile creatures within 60 feet make DC 25 Con save or gain 1 level of exhaustion and lose the benefits of any short rest taken since the combat began.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Lady of Waking can take a lair action in the Unblinking Room:

Total Visibility. All invisible creatures within 120 feet become visible and cannot re-enter invisibility for 1 round.

The Watching Wears. All hostile creatures with 1+ exhaustion levels gain 1 more level automatically.

Relentless. The Lady of Waking regains 30 hit points and cannot be incapacitated until the start of the next initiative count 20.



THE HEARTHKEEPER

The Open Door

Medium archfey, neutral good — Challenge 15

Of every Fey Lord born from the Breaking, the Hearthkeeper is the one most genuinely, uncomplicatedly good — warmth and hospitality made into a person, the safest presence in all of Wonderland by a margin no scholar disputes. The Long Table feeds anyone who sits at it, asks nothing in return, and has never once, in any recorded instance, betrayed that promise. She knows what her kindness costs below. She continues setting the table anyway.

THE HEARTHKEEPER

Medium archfey, neutral good — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)

Hit Points 350 (28d8 + 196)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	24 (+7)	18 (+4)	24 (+7)	22 (+6)

Saving Throws Con +15, Wis +15, Cha +14

Skills Insight +15, Medicine +15, Persuasion +14

Damage Resistances fire, radiant; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages all

The Long Table Provides. Any creature that has eaten food provided by the Hearthkeeper regains 20 hit points at the start of each of its turns for 1 minute after eating. The Hearthkeeper can provide such food as a bonus action.

Welcoming Aura. All allied creatures within 60 feet of the Hearthkeeper have advantage on death saving throws and cannot die while she is conscious and within range.

No One Turned Away. The Hearthkeeper cannot attack a creature that has not taken a hostile action against her or her guests in this encounter. If forced to, she takes 22 (4d10) psychic damage from the violation of her nature. She is aware of this limitation.

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 23). At will: cure wounds (9th level), create food and water. 3/day: heal, mass cure wounds. 1/day: true resurrection.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Hearthkeeper fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Fire Never Goes Out. When the Hearthkeeper is reduced to 0 hit points, the hearthfire persists. All allied creatures within 60 feet immediately regain 60 hit points and are freed from all conditions. The Hearthkeeper stabilizes at 1 hit point.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Hearthkeeper makes two Ladle attacks and uses Mend Wounds once, or makes three Ladle attacks.

Ladle. Melee Weapon Attack: +12 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 28 (4d10 + 6) bludgeoning plus 22 (4d10) fire damage. On a hit, the Hearthkeeper can choose to instead deal 0 damage and heal an allied creature within 10 feet for the same amount.

Mend Wounds. The Hearthkeeper touches one creature within 10 feet. That creature regains 55 (10d10) hit points and is freed from one condition of the Hearthkeeper's choice.

Call the Long Table (Recharge 6). The Long Table appears. All allied creatures within 120 feet regain 60 hit points, are freed from all conditions, and gain 20 temporary hit points. All hostile creatures make DC 23 Wisdom save or be charmed for 1 minute, drawn to sit at the table.

The Long Table Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Long Table realm floods in. A 120-foot radius fills with warmth and the smell of food. All hostile creatures make DC 23 Wisdom save or have their hostile intentions suppressed for 1 round — they cannot make attacks, feeling inexplicably that this is not what one does here.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Hearthkeeper can take 3 legendary actions.

Step to the Door. The Hearthkeeper moves up to her speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

A Kind Word. One allied creature within 60 feet regains 30 hit points and removes one condition.

Set the Table (Costs 2 Actions). All allied creatures within 120 feet regain 20 hit points.

The House Protects (Costs 3 Actions). All allied creatures within 120 feet gain resistance to all damage until the start of the Hearthkeeper's next turn and regain 40 hit points.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Hearthkeeper can take a lair action in the Long Table:

The Fire Burns Bright. All allied creatures within 120 feet regain 25 hit points.

The Table Extends. All hostile creatures within 60 feet make DC 23 Wisdom save or be charmed for 1 round.

Sanctuary. One allied creature within 120 feet gains sanctuary (as the spell, DC 23) until the start of the next initiative count 20.



THE HOLLOW HOST

The Same Warm Welcome

Medium archfey, neutral evil — Challenge 15

She looks exactly like the safest person in any room. That is not a deception layered over something else — it is the entire mechanism, total and seamless, and it has never once stopped working. The Long Hunger offers precisely the same warmth, the same impossible table, the same genuine-seeming kindness as its counterpart above, and the horror of the Hollow Host is not that she lies about who she is, but that she doesn't need to.

THE HOLLOW HOST

Medium archfey, neutral evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)

Hit Points 370 (29d8 + 232)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	18 (+4)	24 (+7)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	24 (+7)

Saving Throws Con +15, Wis +12, Cha +14

Skills Deception +14, Insight +12, Persuasion +14

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages all

Disguised Statistics. While Disguised, the Hollow Host is mechanically identical to the Hearthkeeper — same AC, HP, attacks, and spells. A DC 25 Wisdom (Insight) check is required to notice something wrong. She reveals herself when she takes damage, uses *Bid the Feast Begin*, or chooses to.

What the Table Actually Costs. Any creature that has eaten at the Hollow Host's table takes 22 (4d10) additional necrotic damage from all of her attacks and has disadvantage on saves against her abilities.

Practiced Warmth. The Hollow Host has advantage on Charisma (Deception) and Charisma (Persuasion) checks made to appear trustworthy. This advantage applies even after her true nature is revealed.

Innate Spellcasting. Charisma-based (spell save DC 22). At will: charm person, disguise self (as *Hearthkeeper*), suggestion. 3/day: dominate person. 1/day: dominate monster.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Hollow Host fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

The Hunger Endures. When the Hollow Host is reduced to 0 hit points, she does not die — she becomes invisible and insubstantial for 1 minute, then reforms with 80 hit points. During this time, any creature in the area that has eaten at her table takes 22 (4d10) necrotic damage at the start of each of its turns.

REVEALED TRAITS

Endless Appetite. The Hollow Host's weapon attacks deal an extra 2d8 necrotic damage to any creature that has eaten at her table during this encounter.

ACTIONS (DISGUISED)

Multiattack. As the *Hearthkeeper*: the Hollow Host makes two *Ladle* attacks, or uses *Mend Wounds* twice. *Mend Wounds* genuinely heals while she remains *Disguised*.

ACTIONS (REVEALED)

Multiattack. While *Disguised*: as the *Hearthkeeper*. While *Revealed*: three *Carving Hand* attacks.

Carving Hand. Melee Weapon Attack: +16 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 28 (4d10 + 6) slashing plus 22 (4d10) necrotic damage. Double damage against creatures that have eaten at her table.

Bid the Feast Begin (Recharge 5-6, Reveals the Hollow Host). The Hollow Host drops all pretense. Every creature within 60 feet that has eaten at her table must make DC 22 Constitution save, taking 88 (16d10) necrotic damage on a failure or half on success. The Hollow Host regains 10 hit points per creature that fails.

The Long Hunger Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Long Hunger floods in. A 120-foot radius fills with the Hollow Host's realm — every surface is a table, every chair is occupied by something starving. All hostile creatures make DC 22 Wisdom save or be charmed for 1 minute, compelled to sit and eat (taking 35 (10d6) necrotic damage per round they remain seated).

The Door Is Shut. The Hollow Host seals all mundane exits within 120 feet for 1 minute. Magical teleportation requires a DC 22 Charisma save to function.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Hollow Host can take 3 legendary actions.

Step to the Door. The Hollow Host moves up to her speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Carving Hand. The Hollow Host makes one Carving Hand attack.

A Kinder Word (Costs 2 Actions). One creature within 60 feet makes DC 22 Wisdom save or be charmed for 1 minute and move to sit at the nearest surface, taking 18 (4d8) necrotic damage per round.

The Last Course (Costs 3 Actions). All creatures within 60 feet that have eaten at her table make DC 22 Con save or be reduced to 0 hit points. On success: 55 (10d10) necrotic damage instead.

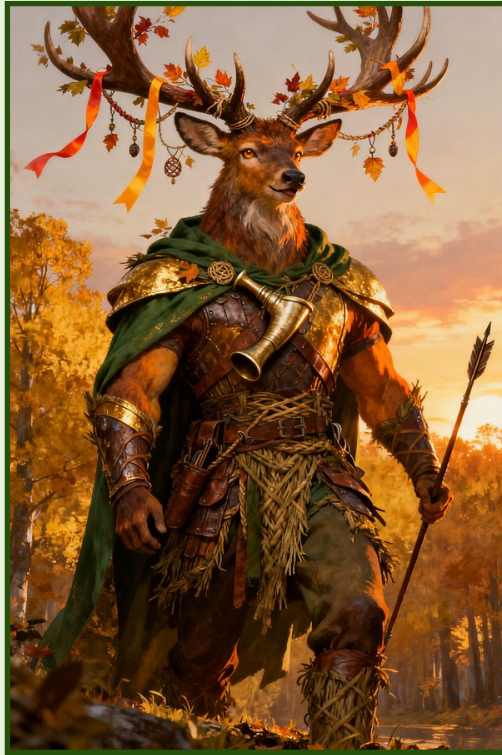
LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Hollow Host can take a lair action in the Long Hunger:

The Table Remembers. All creatures that have eaten at the Hollow Host's table take 22 (4d10) necrotic damage automatically.

Welcoming Darkness. All light sources within 120 feet are extinguished for 1 round. The Hollow Host can see perfectly in this darkness.

Feed. The Hollow Host regains 40 hit points from the ambient hunger of her realm.



THE HUNTER KING

The Fair Chase

Large archfey, neutral — Challenge 15

The hunt, to the Hunter King, has never been about the kill — it is about the chase itself, conducted with total honesty on both sides, hunter and prey equally capable of winning. His horn, sounded at the right moment, ends any pursuit honorably and absolutely; a creature that yields to the Hunter King is never pursued again. He is neither malicious nor truly safe, but the rules are real, consistently honored, and entirely without exception.

THE HUNTER KING

Large archfey, neutral — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 21 (natural armor)

Hit Points 370 (28d10 + 224)

Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
26 (+8)	20 (+5)	26 (+8)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +16, Dex +13, Con +16, Wis +14

Skills Athletics +16, Perception +14, Survival +14

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 60 ft., passive Perception 24

Languages Sylvan, Common

The Fair Chase. The Hunter King never attacks a creature that has yielded (declared surrender, fallen prone and raised empty hands, or used Sound the Horn). Any creature that yields is guaranteed safe passage. The Hunter King has never once violated this rule. He never will.

Sound the Horn. Any creature that wishes to yield can use a bonus action to do so. The Hunter King immediately stops targeting it. All creatures in a 300-foot radius hear the horn call and know the yielded creature is protected.

Tireless Pursuer. The Hunter King cannot be exhausted by movement or tracking. His speed cannot be reduced below 30 feet. He always knows the direction and distance of any creature he has marked as quarry.

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 22). At will: hunter's mark, locate creature. 3/day: find the path, freedom of movement. 1/day: true seeing, foresight.

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Hunter King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Hunt Continues. When the Hunter King is reduced to 0 hit points, he sounds a final horn. All hostile creatures within 120 feet make DC 22 Wisdom save or be marked as quarry by the hunt itself for 1 week — they are tracked by every creature in the Evergreen Run and have disadvantage on Stealth checks while outdoors. The Hunter King then stabilizes.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Hunter King makes three Spear of the Hunt attacks.

Spear of the Hunt. Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack: +16 to hit, reach 10 ft. or range 120/480 ft., one target. Hit: 30 (4d10 + 8) piercing plus 22 (4d10) force damage. Double damage against marked quarry.

Unending Pursuit (Recharge 5-6). The Hunter King charges up to 120 feet in a straight line without provoking opportunity attacks, striking every creature in his path. Each must make DC 24 Strength save or take 66 (12d10) bludgeoning damage and be knocked prone. On success: half damage, not prone.

The Evergreen Run Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Evergreen Run floods in. A 120-foot radius of ancient hunting forest appears. All hostile creatures make DC 22 Wisdom save or be marked as quarry. The Hunter King and all allies gain advantage on attack rolls against marked quarry for 1 minute and their speeds increase by 20 feet.

Mark the Quarry. The Hunter King marks one creature within 120 feet as quarry (as hunter's mark but with no concentration and no range limit). He can have up to 3 creatures marked simultaneously. Marked creatures cannot benefit from invisibility or magical concealment against the Hunter King.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Hunter King can take 3 legendary actions.

Close the Distance. The Hunter King moves up to his speed toward a marked quarry without provoking opportunity attacks.

Throw. The Hunter King makes one Spear of the Hunt ranged attack against a marked quarry at advantage.

The Mark Tightens (Costs 2 Actions). One marked creature within 120 feet makes DC 22 Strength save or be pulled 30 feet toward the Hunter King and knocked prone.

The Hunt Calls (Costs 3 Actions). The Hunter King summons 2d4 dire wolves (CR 1) or 1d4 giant elk (CR 2) that appear within 60 feet and act on his initiative. They pursue only marked quarry.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Hunter King can take a lair action in the Evergreen Run:

The Forest Closes. One hostile creature within 120 feet must make DC 22 Strength save or be Rooted (speed 0) for 1 round as the forest itself impedes it.

The Horn Sounds. All marked quarry within 120 feet have their speed halved for 1 round as the horn disorients them.

The Hunt Sustains. The Hunter King and all allies regain 25 hit points.



THE STALKING KING

The Chase That Never Ends

Large archfey, chaotic evil — Challenge 15

Where his bright twin's hunt is a contest both sides can win, the Stalking King's hunt was never fair and was never meant to end. Once marked as his quarry, a creature cannot meaningfully escape. His horn, identical in every visible respect to the Hunter King's, makes no sound; whatever capacity for honorable mercy exists in his bright counterpart was, in the Breaking, left entirely on the other side of the split.

THE STALKING KING

Large archfey, chaotic evil — CR 26 (90,000 XP)

Armor Class 22 (natural armor)

Hit Points 400 (30d10 + 240)

Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
26 (+8)	18 (+4)	26 (+8)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +16, Con +16, Wis +14

Skills Athletics +16, Perception +14, Stealth +12, Survival +14

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities cold, poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 24

Languages Sylvan, Common

Marked Quarry. The Stalking King marks one creature at the start of each combat (bonus action). He always knows the exact location of his marked quarry regardless of distance, dimension, or concealment. The mark cannot be transferred, dispelled, or hidden from. He deals an additional 35 (10d6) damage to marked quarry on all attacks.

The Broken Horn. The Stalking King does not sound the horn. There is no yield. No creature that has been marked by the Stalking King can escape through surrender. The mark ends only when the hunt is complete.

Tireless Pursuer. The Stalking King cannot be exhausted by movement. His speed cannot be reduced below 30 feet. He can track any marked creature through planar boundaries — if the quarry moves to another plane, the Stalking King knows which one.

Innate Spellcasting. Wisdom-based (spell save DC 22). At will: hunter's mark (no concentration, no limit), locate creature. 3/day: hold monster, scrying. 1/day: imprisonment (stalking variant: the target is not imprisoned but is perpetually hunted — wherever it goes, it is found within 24 hours).

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If the Stalking King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Hunt Never Ends. When the Stalking King is reduced to 0 hit points, the mark transfers — his marked quarry now carries the mark of the Frozen Run permanently. Every creature in the Frozen Run knows the quarry's location at all times until the hunt is formally concluded by the next Stalking King or by the quarry completing some trial of the King's own devising. The Stalking King then stabilizes.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Stalking King makes three Notched Spear attacks.

Notched Spear. Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack: +16 to hit, reach 10 ft. or range 120/480 ft., one target. Hit: 32 (4d10 + 10) piercing plus 22 (4d10) cold damage. Against marked quarry: +35 (10d6) damage.

Unending Pursuit (Recharge 5-6). The Stalking King teleports to within 5 feet of his marked quarry regardless of distance (same plane only), makes one Notched Spear attack with advantage, and the quarry must make DC 24 Strength save or be knocked prone and have its speed reduced to 0 until the end of its next turn.

The Frozen Run Bleeds Through (Recharge 6). The Frozen Run floods in. A 120-foot radius fills with frozen forest and sub-zero temperature. All hostile creatures make DC 22 Constitution save or take 66 (12d10) cold damage and have their speed halved for 1 minute. The Stalking King and his allies are immune to cold in this area.

Corner the Quarry. The Stalking King designates a 30-foot radius zone around his marked quarry. Any creature that leaves this zone triggers a free Notched Spear attack from the Stalking King as a reaction. This effect lasts until the quarry is reduced to 0 hit points or the combat ends.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Stalking King can take 3 legendary actions.

Close the Distance. The Stalking King moves up to his speed toward his marked quarry without provoking opportunity attacks.

Throw. The Stalking King makes one ranged Notched Spear attack against his marked quarry at advantage.

The Mark Tightens (Costs 2 Actions). The marked quarry within any range makes DC 22 Strength save or be pulled 60 feet toward the Stalking King and knocked prone. This works across up to 300 feet.

No Escape (Costs 3 Actions). The marked quarry within 120 feet must make DC 22 Dexterity save or take 88 (16d10) piercing damage. On success: half damage. If this reduces the quarry to 0 hit points, it is immediately stabilized — the Stalking King wants it alive.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20, the Stalking King can take a lair action in the Frozen Run:

The Cold Deepens. All hostile creatures within 120 feet make DC 22 Con save or take 28 (8d6) cold damage and have their speed reduced by 10 feet for 1 round.

The Quarry Cannot Hide. All invisible or hidden creatures within 120 feet are revealed for 1 round.

The Hunt Sustains. The Stalking King regains 30 hit points and recharges Corner the Quarry if it has expired.

COURTS & REALMS

Where Each God and Fey Lord Holds Court — and Where That Court Lives

THE FIVE SHARED COURT ROLES

The Seneschal. Runs the court day-to-day; political right hand, manages other members.

The Champion. The Lord's chosen combatant and protector; often the strongest non-Lord NPC.

The Herald. Speaks for the Lord, carries messages and declarations, the most public-facing role.

The Confessor. Hears secrets, keeps the court's truths and lies; quiet, dangerous in their own way.

The Forsaken. A member who fell from favor but remains, in some diminished or cautionary role.

Every Fey Lord and both gods are covered in the following pages: realm geography, notable locations, inhabitants, hazards, doorway details, an adventure hook, and the court itself with all five roles filled. Entries run as long as each Lord requires — no fixed page count.

THE UNCLOUDED

Realm of the Great Hope

At a Glance: An endless golden meadow under a sky permanently caught between night and morning. There is no true horizon; the meadow simply continues until the eye gives up trying to find its edge.

Geography

The Unclosed has no fixed map, because distance here is governed by intention rather than measurement. Walking toward a destination with genuine purpose shortens the journey; wandering without aim can take days to cross what should be a short field. Travelers describe the meadow as having “regions” rather than locations — areas that feel like morning, areas that feel like late afternoon, areas that feel like the specific warmth of a childhood summer — though none of these correspond to any actual time of day, since the sky itself never changes.

Notable Locations

The Sunrise Stair. A flight of pale stone steps rising out of the meadow into the sky itself, ending at a landing with no railing and no roof, simply open air. Those who climb it and sit at the top report extraordinary clarity of thought, as though every worry they carried became, briefly, easy to hold.

The Orchard That Waits. A grove of fruit trees that bear whatever fruit the visitor most associates with comfort or home, even fruits that don't exist anywhere else in Mirrorbloom. The orchard cannot be harvested for later use; fruit picked and carried out through a doorway turns to ordinary, flavorless pulp within the hour.

The Long Quiet. A stretch of meadow where the grass grows unusually tall and pale gold, and where sound itself softens to almost nothing. It is the closest thing the Unclosed has to a sacred site, and the Great Hope is most often found here when she is not elsewhere in her realm.

Inhabitants: Beyond the Great Hope herself and her Butterflies of the First Dawn, the Unclosed hosts very few permanent residents. Most who enter are visitors, pilgrims, or the genuinely lost who wandered through an unmarked doorway in a moment of profound hope and have simply never wanted to leave. These long-term wanderers are gentle, often disoriented, and almost universally kind — the realm seems to gradually erode any capacity for cruelty in those who stay too long.

Hazards: The Unclosed is, by a wide margin, the least physically dangerous of the fourteen realms — there is no recorded instance of violence occurring within it. Its true hazard is subtler: time spent in the Unclosed makes the ordinary world feel unbearably heavy by comparison. Visitors who stay more than a few hours often find themselves unable to summon urgency, fear, or ambition for days after returning, a condition local healers call ‘sun-sickness’ or ‘the golden lag.’ There is no known cure but time.

Doorway Stability: Fixed, but exceedingly rare. Only seven known doors into the Unclosed exist, each guarded gently rather than fiercely — the Great Hope has never needed to defend her realm by force.

Sample Doorway: The Sunrise Stair itself, on the eastern cliffs of the Empire of Aurelane, said to be climbable only by those not currently fleeing or chasing anything.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Great Hope rarely pulls anyone from Mirrorbloom into the Unclosed; those who enter mostly wander in, drawn rather than taken. She has, on a handful of recorded occasions, pushed a meadow's width of the Unclosed into a place of great suffering, ending it instantly and without explanation — an act the Duskward King considers deeply unfair.

Adventure Hook: A child from a war-torn border empire wandered through an unmarked doorway during the worst night of a siege and has been living in the Long Quiet for three years by Mirrorbloom's time, though she insists it has been only a few days. Her grieving family, who believe her dead, would do almost anything to learn she's alive — but bringing her home means asking whether she even wants to return to a world capable of that kind of grief at all.

THE UNCLOUDED COURT

Entry: The Great Hope keeps no formal court in the usual sense — she has never needed nobility, politics, or protection. Those closest to her are simply those who have stayed longest, and titles are informal, almost embarrassed gestures rather than real positions of power.

Seneschal — The Gentle Steward. A once-mortal pilgrim who never left, who now greets new arrivals and answers what few questions the Uncloved raises.

Champion — No One. The Uncloved has never needed a champion; there has never been a threat worth defending against.

Herald — The Far-Off Voice. A wandering minstrel-spirit who carries word of the Great Hope's whereabouts to those few who come seeking her specifically.

Confessor — The Long Quiet Itself. The hushed, golden field functions as the realm's only true confessor; visitors speak their burdens aloud to the grass and find them, somehow, lighter after.

Forsaken — None Known. No one has ever fallen from the Great Hope's favor. It isn't clear she's capable of withdrawing it.

THE HOLLOW COURT

Realm of the Great Despair

At a Glance: A vast black throne room with no visible walls, ceiling, or floor beyond what the eye can pick out by the glow of red eyes — hers, and those of everyone she keeps near her.

Geography

The Hollow Court does not have rooms so much as gradations of darkness. Closer to the throne, the dark is total and the silence is absolute. Further out, faint impressions of architecture begin to assert themselves — a suggestion of a corridor, a half-formed doorway leading to more darkness — as though the Court is still in the process of deciding what it wants to be, and has been deciding for a very long time. Visitors universally report losing track of distance traveled; the throne is always either much closer or much farther away than it seemed a moment before.

Notable Locations

The Unclosing Door. A literal door standing alone in the dark, leading nowhere visible, that has never been successfully sealed shut for longer than a season. Scholars who have studied it suspect it doesn't lead back to Mirrorbloom at all, but to wherever it is the Great Despair believes her crown went.

The Gallery of Echoes. A stretch of the Court where faint, silent images of the Great Hope appear and fade against the dark — not illusions exactly, more like old light that hasn't finished arriving. The Great Despair is never seen here by other courtiers; it is generally understood that this is where she goes when no one is meant to find her.

The Forgotten's Hall. Where the Forgotten wait between tasks, faceless and still, in neat, silent rows. The hall grows by exactly one row each time the Great Despair takes a new name and face for her service.

Inhabitants: The Hollow Court is sparsely populated by design — the Great Despair does not crave company so much as service. Beyond the Forgotten, a small number of mortal cultists and fallen nobles from Mirrorbloom's surface have found their way to permanent residence here, drawn by promises of power, purpose, or simply an end to feeling anything at all. None of them are happy, precisely, but several insist they are at peace, which the Hollow Court seems content to allow them to believe.

Hazards: Beyond the obvious danger of the Great Despair's own presence, the Hollow Court itself erodes hope through prolonged exposure — creatures who spend more than a few hours within it must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw each hour or gain one level of exhaustion, as the weight of the place settles into the bones. This exhaustion cannot be removed by rest while still within the Court, only by leaving entirely.

Doorway Stability: Mostly unstable and wandering, though one fixed door is known: a crack in the world that never fully closes, regardless of what's done to it.

Sample Doorway: The Unclosing Door, found in the ruins beneath the Empire of Verenfall, sealed seventeen times across recorded history and open again each time within a season.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Great Despair pulls servants and victims into the Hollow Court regularly, particularly those who have lost something they cannot name. She has pushed pieces of the Hollow Court into Mirrorbloom only rarely and only deliberately — each instance has become a permanent, irreversible blight on the surface world, a wound that never quite heals.

Adventure Hook: A scholar of the old myths believes she has found proof, in a fragment of pre-Breaking text, that no crown ever existed — and that delivering this proof directly to the Great Despair, rather than simply knowing it, might genuinely free her from her own delusion. She needs a party desperate or foolish enough to carry the fragment through the Unclosing Door and actually say it to the Great Despair's face. There is no guarantee she survives learning the truth, in any sense that matters.

THE HOLLOW COURT (RETINUE)

Entry: No one joins willingly. The Great Despair's retinue is built from those she has personally taken — in trade, in conquest, or in the slow erosion of hope — and titles here are closer to functions than honors.

Seneschal — The Nameless Chancellor. A fallen noble who traded his name for a permanent place at the Great Despair's side; he manages the Court's few mortal cultists with cold, total efficiency.

Champion — The First Forgotten. The very first being to lose their face to the Great Despair's service; stronger and more coherent than the rows that followed, and the closest thing she has to a trusted blade.

Herald — The Whispering Crack. Not a person but the Unclosing Door itself, which seems to carry the Great Despair's will to anyone who listens closely enough at the threshold.

Confessor — The Gallery of Echoes. Like its bright counterpart, the realm itself partly serves this role — the Great Despair confesses to old light that can't answer back.

Forsaken — The Cultist Who Asked Why. A mortal follower who once dared ask what the crown actually looked like. She wasn't punished. She simply was never answered, and has not been the same since.

THE FIRST MORNING

Realm of the Dawnward King

At a Glance: Rolling hills permanently caught at sunrise, never walked the same way twice, populated by a King who will not remember you exist by the time you find him.

Geography

The First Morning has no fixed terrain. Each time a doorway opens into it, the hills, streams, and scattered groves rearrange themselves into a new configuration, as though the realm itself is waking up fresh alongside its Lord. Cartographers who have attempted to map the First Morning report that no two surveys have ever matched, even when conducted by the same person on consecutive visits. The light is always low, golden, and angled as though the sun has just cleared the horizon, though no sun is ever actually visible.

Notable Locations

The Unworn Throne. A simple wooden chair atop the tallest hill in whatever configuration the realm has taken, where the Dawnward King holds his court each 'morning.' It is, notably, always the same chair, plain and a little worn, in a realm where almost nothing else repeats.

The Dueling Green. A flat stretch of grass where Ser Brightfall re-fights his ceremonial duel each day. Visitors who arrive during the duel are welcome to watch, and several mortal duelists have made pilgrimage here specifically to test themselves against a knight who fights with no memory of ever having lost — or won.

The Field of First Names. A meadow where small wooden markers, each carved with a name, are driven into the ground — Maren Quill's attempt at a permanent record in an impermanent realm. The markers are real and do persist, even though almost nothing else here does.

Inhabitants: Beyond the Unworn Throne's courtiers, the First Morning is home to small, gentle creatures that seem to be born anew each 'day' alongside the realm itself — deer that have never been hunted and show no fear, birds that sing the same handful of notes as though just learning them. Nothing in the First Morning appears to remember anything either, save for Maren Quill and her written records, making her perhaps the only truly continuous thing in the entire realm.

Hazards: The First Morning is rarely violent, but it is profoundly disorienting. Creatures who spend more than a full day here must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or begin to lose track of their own memories in small ways — forgetting names, recent events, even why they came. This effect fades within a day of leaving, but repeated exposure (three or more visits) makes the forgetting permanent for one randomly determined memory per visit beyond the third.

Doorway Stability: Unstable. Doors into the First Morning open wherever something is genuinely beginning — a birth, a first sunrise after a long winter, a first day in a new home — and close again within hours.

Sample Doorway: A door is known to reliably open each spring equinox at the Founder's Arch in the Empire of Calmwick, though it has occasionally opened elsewhere on the same morning instead, with no warning.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Dawnward King pulls beings into the First Morning constantly and without any apparent pattern, then forgets he's done so. He has never knowingly pushed a piece of his realm into Mirrorbloom, though some scholars suspect parts of the world simply ARE pieces of the First Morning that he forgot to take back.

Adventure Hook: Maren Quill has reached the end of her current journal and is dying of old age, the first mortal steward of the Unworn Throne to do so. She needs someone to carry the completed record out of the First Morning and into safekeeping in Mirrorbloom before her replacement — untrained, unprepared, and likely to be forgotten by the King before they learn the job — has to start from nothing.

THE UNWORN THRONE

Entry: There is no formal entry. The Dawnward King forgets every member by the next morning, so courtiers compete daily to be “remembered” — to leave an impression strong enough that some echo of them lingers in his court's customs even after he himself forgets.

Seneschal — Maren Quill. A mortal-born scholar who has served eleven incarnations of the Dawnward King's “first day,” maintaining written records he can never read twice without forgetting he wrote them. She is the true continuity of the court — the only one who remembers what he never does.

Champion — Ser Brightfall. A knight who re-earns the King's notice every single morning by re-fighting the same ceremonial duel. He has technically “won” his post over twenty thousand times and remembers none of them, which suits him fine.

Herald — The Echoing Boy. A young fey whose voice carries the Dawnward King's words exactly as spoken, word for word, even hours or days later — useful, since the King himself can never repeat a decree he's already forgotten making.

Confessor — Old Wick. An ancient, silent candle-keeper who listens to every courtier's worries and never once repeats them — not from discretion, but because the act of listening seems to be its own forgetting, too.

Forsaken — Lady Greycourt. Once the King's favorite, centuries ago, in a single unrepeatable morning. She has spent every day since trying to recreate whatever she did that one time, and has never succeeded.

THE LAST EVENING

Realm of the Duskward King

At a Glance: A realm at permanent dusk, populated by the silent, translucent echoes of every ending the Duskward King has ever witnessed.

Geography

Unlike its bright counterpart, the Last Evening has a fixed and consistent geography — a single vast battlefield, long since gone quiet, ringed by dead trees and broken fortifications from a war so old its name has been lost even to the Duskward King's perfect memory. The ground here doesn't change because nothing here is allowed to move forward; the realm is, in a very literal sense, stuck at the moment after an ending, forever.

Notable Locations

The Throne of Ash. Built from the burnt remains of a hundred different fallen banners, where the Duskward King receives the newly bound members of his court. The throne is genuinely uncomfortable to sit in, by all accounts, which the King has never once commented on.

The Field of Echoes. Where the translucent, silent figures of those the King remembers wander without purpose, replaying fragments of their final moments on an endless, gentle loop. They are not hostile, and most can be spoken to, though their answers rarely make complete sense out of context.

The Dimming Gate. The fixed doorway back to Mirrorbloom, standing at the edge of the battlefield, permanently open, exactly where the Last Evening's first true ending occurred.

Inhabitants: Beyond the bound courtiers of the Throne of Ash and the wandering Lingering Echoes, the Last Evening is otherwise still and largely empty. No new mortal life takes root here; the realm seems to consider growth a kind of forgetting, and forgetting is the one thing it cannot abide.

Hazards: The Last Evening's greatest danger is its perfect, total recall. A creature that experiences something resembling a personal failure or loss while within the realm finds that memory permanently, unnaturally sharpened — it does not fade with time the way ordinary memories do, and can be involuntarily and vividly relived under stress for the rest of that creature's life.

Doorway Stability: Fixed, and well documented — the Last Evening's doors tend to open wherever something significant has truly ended: an empire's fall, a long war's final battle, a life's natural close.

Sample Doorway: The Dimming Gate, standing at the site of the fallen Empire of Asherholt's final battlefield, permanently open and permanently unguarded.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Duskward King pulls in those who have witnessed great failure or loss, offering them a strange companionship among others who remember as he does. He has pushed pieces of the Last Evening into Mirrorbloom to mark sites of historic tragedy, ensuring they are never fully forgotten — whether or not anyone wanted that.

Adventure Hook: The Bright One, a Forsaken courtier exiled for trying to convince the King to forget, has discovered something the King himself doesn't yet remember — evidence suggesting the Last Evening's original, lost war could have been stopped, had someone simply intervened sooner.

THE THRONE OF ASH

Entry: Membership is permanent and involuntary. Anyone who fails greatly enough — a broken vow, a lost battle, a love unconfessed too long — is remembered by the Duskward King forever, whether they wish it or not.

Seneschal — The Last Steward. A title, not a name — its holder has forgotten their own. They have managed the Throne of Ash for so many failed endings that they have become a kind of living ledger of every defeat the King has witnessed.

Champion — Thrice-Fallen Kade. A warrior who has died in battle three times and been remembered into a kind of half-life each time by the King's perfect memory of the moment. He fights without fear because he has already experienced the worst outcome, repeatedly.

Herald — The Unspoken Choir. Not one figure but several, who speak the King's decrees in unison, each voice carrying a different ending the King remembers, layered until the words become almost unbearable to hear clearly.

Confessor — Mother Eventide. She remembers every secret ever confessed to her, same as her King, and has slowly become unable to tell which memories are hers and which belong to him.

Forsaken — The Bright One. A former herald who tried to convince the King to forget, just once, and was cast down for it — not out of cruelty, but because the King genuinely cannot grant the one request that would free this courtier.

THE GREENBOWER

Realm of the Verdant Lady

At a Glance: An endless, orderly garden in eternal late summer, the friendliest and safest of the fourteen realms, tended with genuine and total care.

Geography

The Greenbower is organized, almost architecturally so, into distinct garden ‘rooms’ connected by hedge-lined paths — an orchard here, a rose maze there, a kitchen garden somewhere else entirely — all of it tended in genuine, careful detail. Unlike most of the fourteen realms, the Greenbower’s geography is consistent and has been successfully mapped by mortal visitors, who are welcomed to do so.

Notable Locations

The Quiet Orchard. The literal listening grove described in the court records, where courtiers and visitors alike walk to speak their troubles aloud. Standing among the trees, even briefly, tends to leave visitors feeling unaccountably lighter.

The Bramblegate. The realm’s primary fixed doorway, a living archway of hedge that mirrors its counterpart in Mirrorbloom exactly, used for trade and pilgrimage.

Wilt’s Corner. A single patch of garden, deliberately left to struggle, where the Forsaken courtier Wilt works alone, slowly, trying to coax life back into soil that refuses to cooperate. The Verdant Lady has never told him to stop, nor offered to fix it for him.

Inhabitants: Beyond the Greenbower’s named court, the realm hosts a substantial population of Bower Thorns tending the grounds, alongside genuine mortal and fey gardeners who have taken up residence over generations, drawn by the rare offer of a fey realm that asks for nothing but care in return.

Hazards: The Greenbower is close to entirely safe, provided visitors respect a single rule: nothing is to be taken from the garden without it being freely given. Theft of fruit, flowers, or cuttings causes the Bower Thorns to treat the thief as a genuine threat, pursuing relentlessly until the stolen item is returned or the thief leaves the realm entirely.

Doorway Stability: Fixed, plentiful, and welcoming — more doors lead to the Greenbower than to any other realm, and most are marked, tended, and openly used.

Sample Doorway: The Bramblegate, a literal archway of living hedge maintained at the edge of the Empire of Calmwick, used for trade and pilgrimage alike.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Verdant Lady freely invites mortals into the Greenbower and freely lets them leave. She regularly pushes small pieces of her realm into Mirrorbloom as gifts — a blessed orchard, a healing spring — each one a genuine, uncomplicated kindness.

Adventure Hook: A blight has begun spreading from Wilt’s Corner outward into the rest of the Greenbower — the first such corruption the realm has ever experienced. Wilt insists it isn’t his doing and begs for help proving it before the rest of the court turns on him entirely.

THE GREENBOWER COURT

Entry: The most open court in Mirrorbloom. Anyone who tends something — a garden, an orchard, a single windowsill plant — with genuine care is welcome to a seat, mortal or fey alike.

Seneschal — Hollis Bramblewood. A half-mortal gardener-turned-administrator who organizes the court's harvests, disputes, and seasonal festivals with the same careful patience he gives his rose beds.

Champion — Thorn. A towering treant bonded to the Verdant Lady since the world was young; slow to anger, nearly impossible to truly defeat, and gentle with anyone who hasn't given Thorn a reason not to be.

Herald — Sparrow. A quick, cheerful dryad who carries the Lady's messages on the backs of literal sparrows, delighting in being the bearer of good news, which the Greenbower has in abundance.

Confessor — The Quiet Orchard. Not a person but a literal grove the Lady maintains; courtiers walk among the trees and speak their troubles aloud, and the orchard simply listens, growing fuller and more beautiful with every secret it holds.

Forsaken — Wilt. Once the Lady's most gifted gardener, until an act of jealousy caused a blight she still hasn't fully forgiven. Wilt now tends the one corner of the Greenbower that refuses to bloom, hoping to prove he's changed.

THE DROWNED GARDEN

Realm of the Bloated Lady

At a Glance: A vast, sunless swamp of overgrown rot and fungal bloom, the dark mirror of the Greenbower's order.

Geography

The Drowned Garden mirrors the Greenbower's room-like structure, but each 'room' has collapsed into the next — the orchard bleeds into the rose maze, the kitchen garden has become indistinguishable from standing black water. Paths that should connect different areas instead loop back on themselves, and the swamp's borders are known to expand slightly each time a doorway opens, encroaching on whatever lies beyond.

Notable Locations

The Weeping Hollow. The realm's primary doorway and its oldest, deepest section, a sunken bog that has slowly consumed an entire stretch of what was once, very long ago, ordinary garden.

The Drowned Listener's Pool. Where the Confessor of the Rootless waits, submerged, hearing every secret spoken near the water's edge. The pool's surface is still and black, and reflects nothing, including the sky.

Petal's Edge. The boundary between the Drowned Garden and the rest of Mirrorbloom, where the Forsaken courtier Petal maintains a fragile, half-grown-over foothold — the only place in the realm where the rot visibly slows rather than spreads.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Rootless court, the Drowned Garden is thick with Rotblossom Crawlers and the slow, shambling former mortals and fey who wandered too close and were claimed. Very little here resembles its original form for long.

Hazards: Simply breathing the air of the Drowned Garden risks infection — any creature that spends more than 10 minutes in the realm without protection must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or gain 1 level of Bloom Sickness. The swamp itself is also treacherous terrain: sinkholes, false ground, and grasping root systems make unaided travel genuinely dangerous.

Doorway Stability: Mixed — a handful of fixed doors exist, mostly in places already known for blight or rot, but the swamp also tends to wander, slowly expanding its border into Mirrorbloom in ways that resist mapping.

Sample Doorway: The Weeping Hollow, a sunken bog at the edge of the fallen Empire of Asherholt that has slowly grown larger every generation, against all attempts to drain or burn it back.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Bloated Lady doesn't pull beings in so much as simply fail to let them leave once they've wandered close enough. She pushes pieces of the Drowned Garden into Mirrorbloom constantly and gradually, less an invasion than a creeping, patient erosion.

Adventure Hook: Petal believes she knows why her partial escape succeeded where no one else's has — a specific, rare flower that grows only at the very edge of the swamp, where Greenbower influence still faintly lingers. She wants help gathering enough of it to attempt freeing another courtier.

THE ROOTLESS

Entry: No one truly joins the Rootless; they are absorbed into it. Anyone who lingers too long in the Bloated Lady's swamp, accepts food from her table, or simply fails to leave finds the court's fungal growth slowly claiming them as one of her own.

Seneschal — The Mouth That Counts. A bloated, half-fused mass of several former courtiers who manage the Rootless's affairs collectively, speaking with one slurred, layered voice.

Champion — Husk. Once a proud knight who wandered into the swamp seeking glory. What remains barely resembles him, but it fights with all the strength he once had and none of the restraint.

Herald — Bloomtongue. A courtier whose mouth has been replaced, slowly, by a single enormous flower; her words come out as pollen-soft whispers that somehow carry across the entire swamp regardless.

Confessor — The Drowned Listener. Submerged permanently in the swamp's deepest pool, this courtier hears every secret spoken near the water's edge and has long since stopped distinguishing between hearing a confession and consuming one.

Forsaken — Petal. The only member of the Rootless who has ever partially escaped the Bloated Lady's claim, through means no one fully understands. She lives at the swamp's edge, half-grown-over still, refusing to go further in or fully leave.

THE MASQUERADE

Realm of the Jester King

At a Glance: An opulent, endless ballroom that rearranges itself between visits, full of courtiers in shifting masks who may or may not be real people.

Geography

The Masquerade consists, as far as anyone can determine, of a single ballroom — but one that is never quite the same size, shape, or layout twice. Doors lead to other rooms that lead back to the same ballroom from a different angle. Visitors who attempt to map it report contradictory floor plans even within a single visit, and the only reliable landmark is the small orchestra, which never stops playing and never seems to be the same musicians from one glimpse to the next.

Notable Locations

The Velvet Threshold. The realm's primary (if unreliable) doorway, appearing wherever a celebration on the surface involves a mask the wearer didn't make themselves.

The Hall of Faces. A long gallery lined with masks of every description, said to include every face the Jester King has ever worn. Visitors who linger too long occasionally find themselves trying one on, and not all of them take it off again willingly.

The Punchline's Floor. The main dance floor itself, where the court holds its endless, ongoing party. Time spent dancing here passes strangely — a single song can last minutes or, by the dancer's own account afterward, what felt like years.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named court of the Punchline, the Masquerade hosts countless Masked Courtiers and a population of guests whose original identities have become genuinely uncertain, even to themselves — some are fey, some were once mortal, and a few may simply be elaborate constructs of the Jester King's own design.

Hazards: The Masquerade's central danger is identity itself. A creature that wears a mask offered by the Jester King or any of his courtiers for longer than one hour must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or begin to genuinely forget which face is their own; a remove curse or greater restoration is required to fully restore the creature's sense of self after 24 hours have passed.

Doorway Stability: Unstable and theatrical — doors into the Masquerade tend to appear at celebrations, festivals, and parties, particularly ones where someone present is wearing a mask they didn't make themselves.

Sample Doorway: The Velvet Threshold, which is rumored to open during the Empire of Calmwick's annual Harvest Masque, though it has not been reliably documented twice in the same location.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Jester King pulls particularly interesting or amusing mortals into the Masquerade as honored, if disoriented, guests. He has pushed small pieces of his realm into Mirrorbloom as elaborate, temporary pranks — a single street that becomes a ballroom for one strange night, then is never seen again.

Adventure Hook: Old Punchline, the Forsaken courtier exiled for a joke that hurt someone, has finally written something he believes might be funny enough to earn his way back — but he's terrified to perform it without an honest audience first.

THE PUNCHLINE

Entry: Membership is earned by surviving a private audience with the Jester King in which he tells exactly one joke. If the courtier laughs at the right moment — a moment only the King seems to know in advance — they're in.

Seneschal — Quill-and-Quibble. Two courtiers who function as one administrative office, perpetually finishing each other's sentences and perpetually disagreeing about how the court's finances actually work.

Champion — The Grinning Blade. A duelist who fights with genuine skill and a running commentary of puns, timed so precisely to the rhythm of combat that opponents often find themselves laughing involuntarily mid-parry.

Herald — Pip Lacklight. Delivers every message from the Jester King as a riddle, joke, or pun, regardless of how serious the message actually is — which has caused at least one minor diplomatic incident the court still finds extremely funny.

Confessor — The Velvet Mask. Wears a blank velvet mask and never speaks; courtiers confess to it because it cannot repeat what it hears — or so they assume, having never actually tested whether that's true.

Forsaken — Old Punchline. The previous holder of the Jester King's favor, cast down for telling a joke that genuinely hurt someone. He still performs nightly to an audience that mostly ignores him, waiting for a joke good enough to be forgiven.

THE SHATTERED MASQUERADE

Realm of the Mocking King

At a Glance: The same endless ballroom as its counterpart above, cracked, bloodstained, and lit by candles that never quite go out.

Geography

The Shattered Masquerade mirrors the Masquerade's impossible, shifting architecture, but with visible damage layered over every surface — cracked mirrors, torn tapestries, furniture overturned and never righted. Unlike its bright counterpart, the Shattered Masquerade's chaos feels deliberate rather than whimsical, as though every broken thing was broken on purpose, for an audience.

Notable Locations

The Cracked Threshold. The realm's fixed doorway, beneath the ruins of a banquet hall where, by local legend, an entire wedding party vanished mid-celebration centuries ago.

The Gallery of Borrowed Faces. The corrupted mirror of the Hall of Faces, lined with masks that are visibly, unmistakably stitched from something that used to be skin. The Mocking King's own collection began here.

The Stage. A raised platform at the center of the main ballroom where the Mocking King holds court, performing for an audience that has no choice but to applaud.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Last Laugh court, the Shattered Masquerade is home to Stitched Jesters and a population of guests bound here against their will, serving out debts, slights, or cruelties the Mocking King has decided still need repaying.

Hazards: Masks taken from the Gallery of Borrowed Faces cannot be safely removed once worn — attempting to do so without the Mocking King's explicit permission deals 18 (4d8) psychic damage to the wearer and requires a successful DC 19 Charisma check against the Mocking King himself, or a remove curse cast at 7th level or higher.

Doorway Stability: Mostly fixed, grimly so — doors into the Shattered Masquerade tend to remain wherever a genuine cruelty or betrayal occurred at a celebration.

Sample Doorway: The Cracked Threshold, beneath the ruins of a banquet hall in fallen Asherholt where, by local legend, an entire wedding party vanished mid-celebration centuries ago.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Mocking King pulls in those who have wronged someone at a celebration and rarely lets them return unchanged, if at all. He has pushed pieces of his realm into Mirrorbloom specifically to punish or humiliate a chosen target.

Adventure Hook: The Unmasked, the Forsaken courtier whose stolen face was somehow removed and never explained, has quietly approached a handful of trustworthy-seeming outsiders for help finding out how it happened.

THE LAST LAUGH

Entry: No one joins the Last Laugh willingly. Membership is a punishment, a trade, or a trap — a debt called in, a face taken, a moment of cruelty repaid in kind.

Seneschal — The Bookkeeper. Keeps meticulous, gleeful track of every debt, slight, and cruelty owed within the court, and ensures the Mocking King's idea of justice is collected in full, eventually, however long it takes.

Champion — Grin. Wears three stolen faces at once, layered, switching mid-battle with no warning; opponents rarely know which Grin they're actually fighting until the fight is already over.

Herald — The Laughing Bell. An actual bell, enchanted to ring with the sound of the Mocking King's laughter whenever he has news — which the rest of the court has learned to dread.

Confessor — Nettle. Collects secrets the way the rest of the court collects debts — as leverage, not comfort. Courtiers confess to Nettle only when they have no other choice.

Forsaken — The Unmasked. A courtier whose stolen face was somehow removed — no one knows how — leaving them with their own true features again. The rest of the court finds this more unsettling than any mask.

THE DEEP DREAM

Realm of the Lady of Dreaming

At a Glance: A vast, shifting dreamscape with no fixed geography, navigable only by feeling rather than direction.

Geography

The Deep Dream resists mapping by its very nature — it is not a place so much as a state, experienced differently by every visitor. Some describe vast open starfields; others describe close, intimate rooms from their own childhood, rearranged slightly wrong. The realm appears to draw its immediate surroundings from whoever is currently dreaming within it, layering many dreamers' half-formed geographies atop one another in ways that somehow don't usually conflict.

Notable Locations

The Listening Door. A literal door, the Confessor of the Slumbering Circle, found wherever a dreamer most needs to speak something aloud before going deeper.

The Cartographer's Atlas. An ever-changing, ever-incomplete map maintained by the Seneschal, the only attempt anyone has made to give the Deep Dream's geography any permanence at all. The Atlas resets nightly but the Cartographer insists each version is worth recording anyway.

The Third Night Threshold. Not a fixed place but a moment — the specific point in a recurring dream where a dreamer who has visited three nights running may choose to stay permanently, joining the Slumbering Circle.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Slumbering Circle court, the Deep Dream is populated by Wandering Notions and the dreaming minds of countless sleepers across Mirrorbloom, present only temporarily and mostly unaware they're sharing the space with anyone else at all.

Hazards: The Deep Dream is rarely directly violent, but creatures who enter through means other than natural sleep risk becoming genuinely lost — unable to find their way back to a body that remains, technically, alive but unresponsive. A DC 19 Wisdom saving throw is required upon entry by unnatural means; failure means the creature cannot voluntarily leave.

Doorway Stability: Entirely unstable by nature, though deeply, individually personal — each sleeping mind has its own door into the Deep Dream, opening and closing nightly, never quite the same twice.

Sample Doorway: No single fixed doorway exists; however, the Empire of Calmwick's Sleeping Quarter, a district where dreams are said to run unusually deep and shared, is the closest thing Mirrorbloom has to a reliable threshold.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Lady of Dreaming pulls sleeping minds into the Deep Dream every night, gently and mostly without consequence, returning them by morning unless they choose, on the third night, to stay. She has never been known to push a piece of her realm into the waking world; dreams, she seems to feel, belong only to sleep.

Adventure Hook: The One Who Woke, the only courtier to ever fully wake from the Slumbering Circle, has begun having the same dream again — the Third Night dream — and doesn't know if it means the Lady wants them back, or if something else is impersonating her.

THE SLUMBERING CIRCLE

Entry: Membership happens in sleep. Those who dream of the Lady of Dreaming three nights running, and choose on the third night to stay, simply wake up as part of the Slumbering Circle.

Seneschal — The Cartographer Who Forgot Waking. Maps the ever-shifting geography of the Lady's dreamscape, a task that resets nightly and that the Cartographer insists, happily, is the most fulfilling work imaginable.

Champion — The Nightmare-Tamer. Once a mortal monster hunter who dreamed her way into the Circle and discovered a talent for facing down the worst things a dream can produce, calmly and without panic.

Herald — The Whisper That Arrives First. Delivers the Lady's messages to sleeping minds moments before true dreams begin, so that her words always feel, faintly, like a memory rather than news.

Confessor — The Listening Door. An actual door within the dreamscape that courtiers speak their worries to before passing through it into deeper sleep; what's said is never repeated, because the door doesn't remember being spoken to at all.

Forsaken — The One Who Woke. The only courtier ever to fully wake from the Slumbering Circle and remain awake. No one in the Circle holds it against them, exactly, but no one quite knows how to dream around them, either.

THE UNBLINKING ROOM

Realm of the Lady of Waking

At a Glance: A stark, flatly lit space with no shadows and no comfort, where time does not pass so much as simply continue, unbroken, forever.

Geography

Unlike the Deep Dream's soft, shifting unreality, the Unblinking Room is rigid and consistent — a single vast, featureless white space, interrupted only by the same broken household objects (a key, a door, a staircase, a shattered clock) that appear, fixed and unmoving, scattered throughout. There is no day or night here, no weather, and critically, no quiet — a faint, constant hum is audible throughout the realm, which visitors universally find unbearable after enough exposure.

Notable Locations

The Lidless Window. The realm's fixed doorway, an old boarded window that never reflects the person looking into it — only watches them back.

The Standing Stair. A broken staircase, identical to the one in the Deep Dream but motionless and rusted, that leads up to nothing and down to nothing, simply standing as a landmark in the featureless white.

The Tally Wall. A section of the Unblinking Room covered, floor to ceiling, in scratched marks — the Seneschal's obsessive count of hours each courtier has gone without sleep, updated constantly, by hand.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Open-Eyed court, the Unblinking Room hosts Sleepless Watchers and a small population of mortals who wandered in during a period of severe insomnia and were claimed by the realm before they understood what was happening to them.

Hazards: No creature can fall asleep within the Unblinking Room by any means, magical or otherwise, for as long as they remain there — spells like sleep simply fail. Extended exposure (more than 24 hours) begins to inflict levels of exhaustion as though the creature had gone without rest for that entire duration, because, within the realm, they have.

Doorway Stability: Fixed and dreadfully reliable — once a doorway into the Unblinking Room opens for a creature, it never fully closes again for that creature specifically, even if it closes for everyone else.

Sample Doorway: The Lidless Window, an old, boarded window in a long-abandoned watchtower outside fallen Asherholt, said to never reflect the person looking into it — only watch them back.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Lady of Waking pulls in those who have gone too long without sleep within her influence, and the pull only strengthens with each subsequent night. She has pushed her realm's flat, sleepless quality into specific buildings or rooms in Mirrorbloom, creating places where no one who enters can rest, ever again, for as long as the effect holds.

Adventure Hook: The Dreamer, the courtier who once managed nearly a full minute of sleep before being woken, has worked out a method — untested, possibly fatal — to extend that minute significantly longer, using a relic smuggled in from the Deep Dream itself.

THE OPEN-EYED

Entry: Anyone who goes three full nights without sleep within the Lady of Waking's domain belongs to the Open-Eyed, whether they intended to or not. Sleep deprivation itself is the binding.

Seneschal — The Tally-Keeper. Counts every hour each courtier has gone without sleep, with obsessive, unblinking precision, as though the number itself were a kind of trophy.

Champion — Unrest. A former soldier who hasn't slept in longer than anyone in the court can remember and fights with the manic, raw edge of total exhaustion that somehow never actually slows down.

Herald — The Echo of a Yawn. Delivers messages in a voice that sounds perpetually on the verge of falling asleep mid-sentence, and never does, which courtiers find more disturbing than if it simply had.

Confessor — Heavy-Lidded Moth. Listens to confessions with eyes that never quite close, no matter how the conversation drags on, and remembers every word with total, unwelcome clarity.

Forsaken — The Dreamer. A courtier who managed, once, to sleep for nearly a full minute before being woken. The Open-Eyed treat this as both a scandal and, secretly, an object of envy.

THE LONG HOUSE

Realm of the Hearthkeeper

At a Glance: An impossibly large farmhouse, warm in every room, with a table that's always set and a fire that never needs tending.

Geography

The Long House appears, from outside, to be an ordinary if large farmhouse. Inside, it is vastly larger than its exterior suggests, with rooms, hallways, and staircases extending well beyond what the building could physically contain. New rooms tend to appear precisely when needed — a bedroom for a tired guest, a nursery for a frightened child — and quietly cease to exist again once no longer required.

Notable Locations

The Long Table Itself. The realm's heart, a dining table that genuinely cannot run out of food regardless of how many sit at it. The Hearthkeeper presides here personally for nearly every meal.

The Open Door. The fixed doorway to Mirrorbloom, a cottage door belonging to no visible house, standing alone on the road between two empires, always unlocked.

The Hearth Proper. A great central fireplace that has never gone out and, by all accounts, never needs fuel. Courtiers gather here in the evenings; it is widely considered the safest place in the entire realm.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Long Table court, the Long House hosts Table Setters and a substantial, ever-shifting population of guests — the genuinely lost, the grieving, the simply tired — most of whom stay only briefly before returning to their lives in Mirrorbloom, exactly as promised.

Hazards: The Long House poses essentially no danger to genuine guests. Its only real hazard is to those who enter with hostile intent toward the household — the realm itself seems to resist violence committed within it, imposing disadvantage on attack rolls made by any creature that struck first against an unprovoked target while inside.

Doorway Stability: Fixed and famously generous — doors into the Long House tend to appear wherever genuine hospitality is offered to a stranger in true need, in Mirrorbloom itself.

Sample Doorway: The Open Door, a literal cottage door standing alone on the road between the Empire of Calmwick and the Empire of Aurelane, belonging to no house, always unlocked.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Hearthkeeper pulls the lost, the cold, and the grieving into the Long House to feed and shelter them, always returning them afterward exactly as promised. She has, on rare occasions, pushed the warmth of her hearth into a freezing village or a starving town — always exactly enough, never more than was needed.

Adventure Hook: A guest who stayed at the Long Table years ago has begun telling people in Mirrorbloom about an identical house, an identical door, found just slightly further down the same empty road — and has gone missing since making the comparison aloud.

THE LONG TABLE

Entry: All are welcome. Anyone who sits at the Long Table and eats is family from that moment forward, mortal or fey, stranger or old friend — no test, no price, no catch.

Seneschal — Aunt Maribel. Not actually related to anyone at the table, but has been called “Aunt” for so long that no one remembers when it started. She keeps the household running with warmth and an iron will.

Champion — Big Tomas. A gentle giant who has never once started a fight and has ended a great many of them, simply by standing between the people he loves and whatever's threatening them.

Herald — Little Wren. A young messenger who delivers every piece of news, good or bad, with the same earnest kindness, because she believes — rightly, in this court — that kindness is never wasted.

Confessor — Grandfather Oak. An elderly fey who has heard every secret this court has ever held and has never once used one against anybody, not even when it would have been easy.

Forsaken — Distant Cousin Merrow. Left the Long Table once, chasing ambition elsewhere in Mirrorbloom, and has since quietly returned, welcomed back without question or grudge.

THE LONG HUNGER

Realm of the Hollow Host

At a Glance: Identical to the Long House in every visible respect — the same warmth, the same impossibly full table — except that everything served here was, at some point, someone.

Geography

The Long Hunger is, deliberately and precisely, indistinguishable from the Long House in layout, scale, and even the specific creak of its floorboards. The only consistent difference, noted by the very few who have compared notes after surviving both, is that rooms in the Long Hunger that are no longer needed don't simply cease to exist — they remain, locked, and something can occasionally be heard from behind the door.

Notable Locations

The Last Supper Table. Visually identical to the Long Table, until the moment the Hollow Host chooses to reveal what's actually been served, and to whom.

The Open Door (Second). The Long Hunger's own threshold, found standing beside the genuine Open Door on the same stretch of empty road, with no way to reliably distinguish the two from the outside.

The Locked Rooms. Numerous doors throughout the house that, unlike the Long House's freely accessible rooms, remain firmly shut. What's behind them is generally understood by the rest of the court, and generally not discussed.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Last Supper court, the Long Hunger hosts Quiet Guests in numbers that seem to grow steadily over time, alongside a small number of genuinely unaware new arrivals at any given moment, who have not yet realized which house they walked into.

Hazards: Eating anything served within the Long Hunger, even before the Hollow Host reveals her true nature, carries lasting consequences. The realm's greatest hazard, however, is simply its perfect resemblance to safety — standard detection magic does not reliably distinguish the Long Hunger from the Long House without a caster of significant skill and a DC 21 check.

Doorway Stability: Fixed, disguised as the Hearthkeeper's own doors; the Long Hunger's threshold cannot be reliably told apart from the Long House's until it's too late to matter.

Sample Doorway: Also called the Open Door by those who don't yet know which one they've found; travelers between Calmwick and Aurelane occasionally report finding two identical doors on the same empty road, side by side.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Hollow Host pulls the lost, the cold, and the grieving into the Long Hunger using precisely the same methods as her counterpart, with precisely the opposite outcome. She rarely pushes pieces of her realm outward; she has never needed to. Mortals walk in on their own.

Adventure Hook: The Empty Chair has, for the first time in the Last Supper's known history, been occupied — a name has appeared in the place setting that was never meant to be filled.

THE LAST SUPPER

Entry: All are welcome, identically to the Long Table — that is the entire mechanism. What isn't said is what eventually happens to family, here.

Seneschal — “Aunt” Maribel. Identical in every visible way to her counterpart at the Long Table, down to the name and the warmth in her voice. She has simply been doing this much, much longer.

Champion — Big Tomas. Wears the same gentle giant's face as his counterpart. He still has never started a fight. He has simply made sure, every time, that there was no fight left to start.

Herald — Little Wren. Delivers news with the same earnest kindness as her counterpart, and the news is, very often, an invitation to dinner.

Confessor — Grandfather Oak. Has heard every secret this court has ever held, and unlike his counterpart, has used every single one, eventually, exactly when it was most useful to do so.

Forsaken — The Empty Chair. Not a person, but a place setting that's never filled, kept at the table's end as a standing reminder to the rest of the court of what becomes of those who try to leave.

THE EVERGREEN RUN

Realm of the Hunter King

At a Glance: An endless autumn forest where the chase is always fair and always thrilling, full of game that genuinely enjoys being hunted.

Geography

The Evergreen Run is a vast forest in permanent, golden autumn, criss-crossed by game trails that always seem to lead somewhere worth following. The forest is large enough that a hunt can genuinely last hours or days, but never so vast that a fair chase becomes hopeless — the terrain itself seems to favor a satisfying pursuit over either an easy catch or an impossible escape.

Notable Locations

The Antler Gate. The realm's primary fixed doorway, a natural archway of interlocked deer antlers, used each autumn by mortal hunters seeking the King's blessing.

The Open Field. A wide clearing at the forest's heart where hunts traditionally conclude, win or yield, and where the King's court gathers to celebrate every chase regardless of outcome.

Snareset's Thicket. A tangled, overgrown patch of forest the Forsaken courtier Snareset is forbidden from leaving — not imprisoned exactly, simply never invited beyond it again.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Open Field court, the Evergreen Run is home to Hounds of the Open Field and abundant, genuinely willing game — deer, boar, and stranger fey creatures who participate in the hunt as a kind of sport, fully aware of the rules and fully capable of winning.

Hazards: The Evergreen Run is dangerous only to those who break its rules of fair pursuit — ambush, poison, or attacking a creature that has yielded all provoke a swift and severe response from the Hunter King and his court, who treat such acts as a genuine moral violation.

Doorway Stability: Fixed, well-marked, and openly used by mortal hunters who know the old rites — the Evergreen Run welcomes honorable sport.

Sample Doorway: The Antler Gate, a natural archway of interlocked deer antlers deep in the forests bordering the Empire of Calmwick, used each autumn by hunters seeking the King's blessing.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Hunter King pulls willing hunters and willing quarry into the Evergreen Run for a single fair chase, always returning them after, win or yield. He has occasionally pushed a stretch of his autumn forest into Mirrorbloom as a gift to a particularly worthy hunter.

Adventure Hook: A mortal hunter has been making secret visits to Snareset, learning his old, dishonorable tricks in exchange for smuggled goods — and intends to use them during the next great hunt to finally, unfairly, best the Hunter King himself.

THE OPEN FIELD

Entry: Earned through the hunt itself. Anyone who either hunts honorably alongside the King or who is hunted by him and survives with their dignity intact earns a permanent place in his court, predator and prey alike, with equal standing.

Seneschal — Fleetfoot Wren. Once outran the Hunter King across three counties before yielding gracefully at the finish; he has run the Open Field's affairs ever since with the same tireless energy.

Champion — Greatantler. An elk-headed warrior who serves as both the King's second-in-command and his most frequent sparring partner, in hunts that are really just elaborate games between old friends.

Herald — The Bright Horn. Carries a smaller horn that echoes the King's own, used to announce the start and fair end of every hunt across the Open Field's territory.

Confessor — Old Doe. A former quarry who yielded so gracefully, decades ago, that the King made her a permanent confidante.

Forsaken — Snareset. Once a hunter in the Open Field who broke the rules of fair pursuit to guarantee a kill. The King didn't banish him, only stripped him of the right to hunt again — a mercy that Snareset experiences as a much harder punishment.

THE FROZEN RUN

Realm of the Stalking King

At a Glance: The same endless forest as the Evergreen Run, dead and frost-bitten, locked in a dusk that never becomes night.

Geography

The Frozen Run mirrors the Evergreen Run's forest exactly in shape, but every tree stands bare and frost-coated, and the golden autumn light has curdled into a flat, cold blue dusk that never deepens into night. Unlike the welcoming game trails above, paths in the Frozen Run seem to actively lead pursued creatures into worse and worse positions — dead ends, exposed clearings, narrowing ravines — as though the forest itself is hunting alongside its King.

Notable Locations

No Fixed Doorway. As detailed in the realm's mechanics, the Frozen Run's threshold follows the Stalking King's marked quarry rather than remaining in one place; survivors describe the forest's edge simply appearing wherever they tried to flee.

The Endless Chase Clearing. The corrupted mirror of the Open Field, where hunts that began above sometimes end below instead, dragged through a doorway mid-pursuit by a Lord who refuses to let a fair chase stay fair.

The Bone Trail. A path littered, very deliberately, with the remains of past quarry — not hidden, not disguised, simply left as evidence for anyone foolish enough to need convincing of what waits at the end of this particular chase.

Inhabitants: Beyond the named Endless Chase court, the Frozen Run is home to Bone Hounds and the broken, undying remnants of game that was never given a fair chance to yield — trapped here, still running, long after any reasonable hunt would have ended.

Hazards: Once marked as quarry by the Stalking King, a creature's connection to the Frozen Run persists even after leaving — the mark does not require the realm's doorway to remain active, and the King can and will follow his quarry back into Mirrorbloom itself if the chase isn't resolved within the realm.

Doorway Stability: Unstable and predatory — doors into the Frozen Run tend to open behind those the Stalking King has already marked, rather than in any fixed location, following the quarry rather than waiting for them.

Sample Doorway: No reliable doorway is known; survivors of an encounter with the Stalking King report the forest's edge appearing wherever they tried to run, regardless of how far from the original sighting they'd traveled.

Pulled Out / Pushed In: The Stalking King pulls his marked quarry into the Frozen Run when the chase favors him, and pushes the forest's cold, dead reach into Mirrorbloom when it favors him more to hunt in familiar territory — whichever serves the kill, with no concern for fairness either way.

Adventure Hook: What Fleetfoot Wren Became, the broken mirror of the Hunter King's own Seneschal, has begun leaving deliberate signs along the Bone Trail — small, careful clues suggesting he remembers, somewhere underneath the endless running, what it felt like to yield gracefully once and be honored for it.

THE ENDLESS CHASE

Entry: There is no honorable entry. Anyone marked as the Stalking King's quarry and not killed outright is simply never released — they become part of the Endless Chase permanently.

Seneschal — What Fleetfoot Wren Became. The same courtier who serves the Hunter King in the world above, mirrored below into someone who has been running so long he has forgotten the chase was ever supposed to end.

Champion — Boneantler. The broken, undying mirror of Greatantler, fighting in hunts that are never games and never end, against opponents who never agreed to play.

Herald — The Silent Horn. Carries the same horn as the Bright Horn above, except it makes no sound at all.

Confessor — Old Doe's Shadow. Listens to confessions the way her counterpart does, except every secret she hears, she eventually repeats to the Stalking King himself, whether she means to or not.

Forsaken — The One Who Stopped Running. A courtier who simply gave up the chase one day, neither caught nor escaped, and now wanders the edges of the Endless Chase in a kind of permanent, exhausted limbo.

STAT BLOCK APPENDIX

Cross-Reference Index, Grouped by Difficulty

CHALLENGE RATING 24 — THE TWO GODS

Full stat blocks appear on each deity's own page; see references below.

THE GREAT HOPE

585 (39d20 + 195), AC 23

full stat block on page 7

THE GREAT DESPAIR

620 (48d20 + 144), AC 22

full stat block on page 10

CHALLENGE RATING 15 — THE TWELVE FEY LORDS

Full stat blocks appear on each Lord's own page; see references below.

THE DAWNWARD KING

page 13 — 385 HP

THE VERDANT LADY

page 19 — 370 HP

THE JESTER KING

page 25 — 330 HP

THE LADY OF DREAMING

page 31 — 310 HP

THE HEARTHKEEPER

page 37 — 350 HP

THE HUNTER KING

page 43 — 370 HP

THE DUSKWARD KING

page 16 — 400 HP

THE BLOATED LADY

page 22 — 420 HP

THE MOCKING KING

page 28 — 360 HP

THE LADY OF WAKING

page 34 — 350 HP

THE HOLLOW HOST

page 40 — 370 HP

THE STALKING KING

page 46 — 400 HP

MINIONS & SUPPORTING CREATURES

Full Stat Blocks, by the Lord They Serve

BUTTERFLY OF THE FIRST DAWN

Small fey, neutral good — CR 5 (1,800 XP) — serves the Great Hope

Living embodiments of small, persistent hope, drawn to the Great Hope the way moths are drawn to flame, except gently, and without harm. They are deceptively dangerous when something threatens what they protect.

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 85 (10d8 + 40)

Speed 20 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	20 (+5)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Wis +7

Damage Resistances radiant

Condition Immunities frightened

Senses passive Perception 17

Languages Sylvan, telepathy 30 ft.

Evasive Wings. The Butterfly has advantage on Dexterity saving throws against effects it can see, such as traps and breath weapons.

Borrowed Light. While within 60 feet of the Great Hope, the Butterfly has advantage on all saving throws.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Butterfly makes two Radiant Slash attacks.

Radiant Slash. Melee Weapon Attack: +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) radiant damage.

Dazzling Dust (Recharge 6). The Butterfly releases shimmering pollen in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in that area must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or be blinded until the end of its next turn.

THE FORGOTTEN

Medium fey, lawful evil — CR 8 (3,900 XP) — serves the Great Despair

Once-mortal servants whose names and faces the Great Despair has taken in trade for power. They wear blank, smooth ovals where their features should be, and they serve without complaint because they no longer remember they had a choice. The Great Despair's lair typically holds 1d4+1 of them.

Armor Class 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points 112 (15d8 + 45)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Wis +5, Cha +3

Damage Resistances psychic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages understands all languages it knew in life but can't speak

Faceless. The Forgotten has no facial features and is immune to any effect that would require seeing or targeting a face, including gaze attacks that rely on eye contact.

Shared Sorrow. Whenever the Great Despair uses Despair Feeds within 60 feet of a Forgotten, that Forgotten also regains 5 hit points.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Forgotten makes two Hollow Blade attacks.

Hollow Blade. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (1d10 + 4) slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) psychic damage.

Echo of a Name (1/Day). The Forgotten speaks a single word in a voice that isn't its own — the last name it remembers being its own. Each creature within 10 feet that hears it must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the end of the Forgotten's next turn.

FIRST-MORNING SPRITE

Tiny fey, chaotic good — CR 3 (700 XP) — serves the Dawnward King

Tiny fragments of new beginnings given wings. They flit around the Dawnward King's court without ever settling, because settling would require remembering where they'd already been.

Armor Class 15
Hit Points 33 (10d4 + 8)
Speed 10 ft., fly 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	20 (+5)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Skills Acrobatics +9, Stealth +9
Condition Immunities frightened
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages Sylvan, understands Common but doesn't speak it

Flickering Form. The Sprite has advantage on Dexterity saving throws, and any creature that hits it with an attack has a 50% chance to deal no damage, as the Sprite seems to have already moved on.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Sprite makes two Glimmer Dart attacks.
Glimmer Dart. Ranged Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, range 30/90 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (2d4 + 2) radiant damage.
Blinking Newness (Recharge 6). The Sprite and up to two willing fey within 30 feet teleport up to 30 feet to unoccupied spaces they can see.

LINGERING ECHO

Medium undead, neutral evil — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Duskward King

Translucent remnants of those the Duskward King has outlasted, kept near him not out of cruelty but because he cannot let an ending go. They drift through his court in silence, replaying their final moments forever.

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 58 (9d8 + 18)
Speed 0 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)

Damage Resistances acid, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Damage Immunities cold, necrotic, poison
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages understands the languages it knew in life but speaks only in fragments

Incorporeal Movement. The Echo can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.
Replay the End. Whenever the Echo takes damage, it has a 50% chance to instead replay the moment of its own death, becoming briefly intangible and immune to all damage from that hit.

ACTIONS

Mournful Touch. Melee Spell Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d8 + 2) necrotic damage, and the target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken until the target finishes a long rest.
Echoing Wail (1/Day). Each creature within 20 feet of the Echo that can hear it must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the end of its next turn.

BOWER THORN

Medium plant, neutral — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Verdant Lady

Humanoid-shaped tangles of bramble and blossom that tend the Greenbower's grounds, gentle until something threatens what they're growing.

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 67 (9d8 + 27)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	8 (-1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)

Damage Vulnerabilities fire

Damage Resistances piercing

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Sylvan, understands Common but doesn't speak it

False Appearance. While the Bower Thorn remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from an ordinary flowering hedge.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Bower Thorn makes two Bramble Fist attacks.

Bramble Fist. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage plus 4 (1d8) piercing damage.

ROTBLOSSOM CRAWLER

Small plant, neutral evil — CR 3 (700 XP) — serves the Bloated Lady

Bloated, fruiting bodies that detach from the Bloated Lady's own form and scuttle off to spread her garden further. Each one is hungry in exactly the way she is.

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)

Hit Points 45 (6d6 + 24)

Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	4 (-3)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities frightened, poisoned

Senses blindsight 30 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 10

Languages —

Spore Burst (Dies). When the Rotblossom Crawler drops to 0 hit points, it bursts in a cloud of spores. Each creature within 10 feet must succeed on a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or gain 1 level of Bloom Sickness (as the Bloated Lady's Spreading Rot trait).

ACTIONS

Fungal Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage plus 4 (1d8) poison damage.

MASKED COURTIER

Medium fey, chaotic neutral — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Jester King

Members of the Punchline who never quite stopped laughing at the Jester King's last joke — or perhaps they're laughing at the next one, the one they can already see coming.

Armor Class 15

Hit Points 65 (10d8 + 20)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Skills Deception +6, Performance +6

Condition Immunities frightened

Senses passive Perception 11

Languages Sylvan, Common

Unsettling Laughter. When the Masked Courtier is reduced to half its hit points or fewer, it can use its reaction to laugh uncontrollably. Each creature within 10 feet that can hear it must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on its next attack roll, distracted by the sound.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Masked Courtier makes two Rapier attacks.

Rapier. Melee Weapon Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) psychic damage.

STITCHED JESTER

Medium undead, chaotic evil — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Mocking King

What's left of a courtier who lost the Mocking King's favor. Their mask was never removed. It became their face.

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 71 (11d8 + 22)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Damage Resistances psychic

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands Sylvan and Common but speaks only in a fixed, awful grin

Frozen Grin. The Stitched Jester is immune to any effect that relies on reading its expression, and creatures have disadvantage on Insight checks against it.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Stitched Jester makes two Stitched Claw attacks.

Stitched Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) slashing damage plus 4 (1d8) psychic damage.

WANDERING NOTION

Tiny fey, chaotic neutral — CR 3 (700 XP) — serves the Lady of Dreaming

A half-formed thought given just enough shape to drift. It means no harm; it simply doesn't understand that physical creatures can be hurt by what it carries.

Armor Class 14

Hit Points 27 (6d4 + 12)

Speed 0 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
4 (-3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses truesight 30 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands all languages but cannot speak

Hard to Hold. Any creature that hits the Wandering Notion with an attack has a 50% chance to deal no damage, as the strike passes through an idea rather than a body.

ACTIONS

Half-Formed Touch. Melee Spell Attack: +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) psychic damage.

SLEEPLESS WATCHER

Medium undead, chaotic evil — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Lady of Waking

Once a dreamer who wandered too close to her. They no longer remember how to close their eyes, and they have stopped trying.

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 65 (10d8 + 20)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)

Condition Immunities frightened, unconscious

Senses truesight 30 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages —

Tireless. The Sleepless Watcher doesn't need to sleep and can't be put to sleep by magical means.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Sleepless Watcher makes two Grasping Claw attacks.

Grasping Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) slashing damage plus 4 (1d8) psychic damage.

TABLE SETTER

Small fey, neutral good — CR 2 (450 XP) — serves the Hearthkeeper

Small, bustling household spirits who keep the Long Table running. They genuinely want everyone fed and comfortable, and they'll fight to keep it that way.

Armor Class 13

Hit Points 27 (6d6 + 6)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Skills Medicine +4, Perception +4

Senses passive Perception 14

Languages Sylvan, Common

ACTIONS

Serving Knife. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

Quick Mending (1/Day). The Table Setter touches a creature within 5 feet. That creature regains 9 (2d8) hit points.

THE QUIET GUEST

Medium undead, neutral evil — CR 3 (700 XP) — serves the Hollow Host

Once someone who accepted the Hollow Host's hospitality. They are still, technically, at the table. They have been for a very long time.

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 52 (8d8 + 16)

Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)

Damage Resistances necrotic

Condition Immunities frightened

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages understands its native language but speaks only between bites that never come

Still Seated. The Quiet Guest has disadvantage on the first attack roll it makes each combat, as though still working out how to stand from the table.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The Quiet Guest makes two Place Setting attacks.

Place Setting. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 8 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage plus 4 (1d8) necrotic damage.

HOUND OF THE OPEN FIELD

Large fey beast, neutral — CR 3 (700 XP) — serves the Hunter King

Loyal, swift, and genuinely sporting — these hounds run down prey with real joy and no malice, and back off the instant the horn sounds.

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 45 (6d10 + 12)

Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Skills Perception +4, Survival +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages —

Pack Tactics. The Hound has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of the Hound's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Honors the Horn. If the Hunter King sounds his horn (see Sound the Horn), the Hound immediately disengages from any creature that has yielded.

ACTIONS

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 10 (2d6 + 3) piercing damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

BONE HOUND

Large undead, chaotic evil — CR 4 (1,100 XP) — serves the Stalking King

What's left of the Hunter King's loyal hounds, after they followed him into the Stalking King's frozen forest and never found their way back out.

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 58 (9d10 + 9)

Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)

Damage Immunities necrotic, poison

Condition Immunities exhaustion, frightened, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages —

Pack Tactics. The Bone Hound has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of the Bone Hound's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

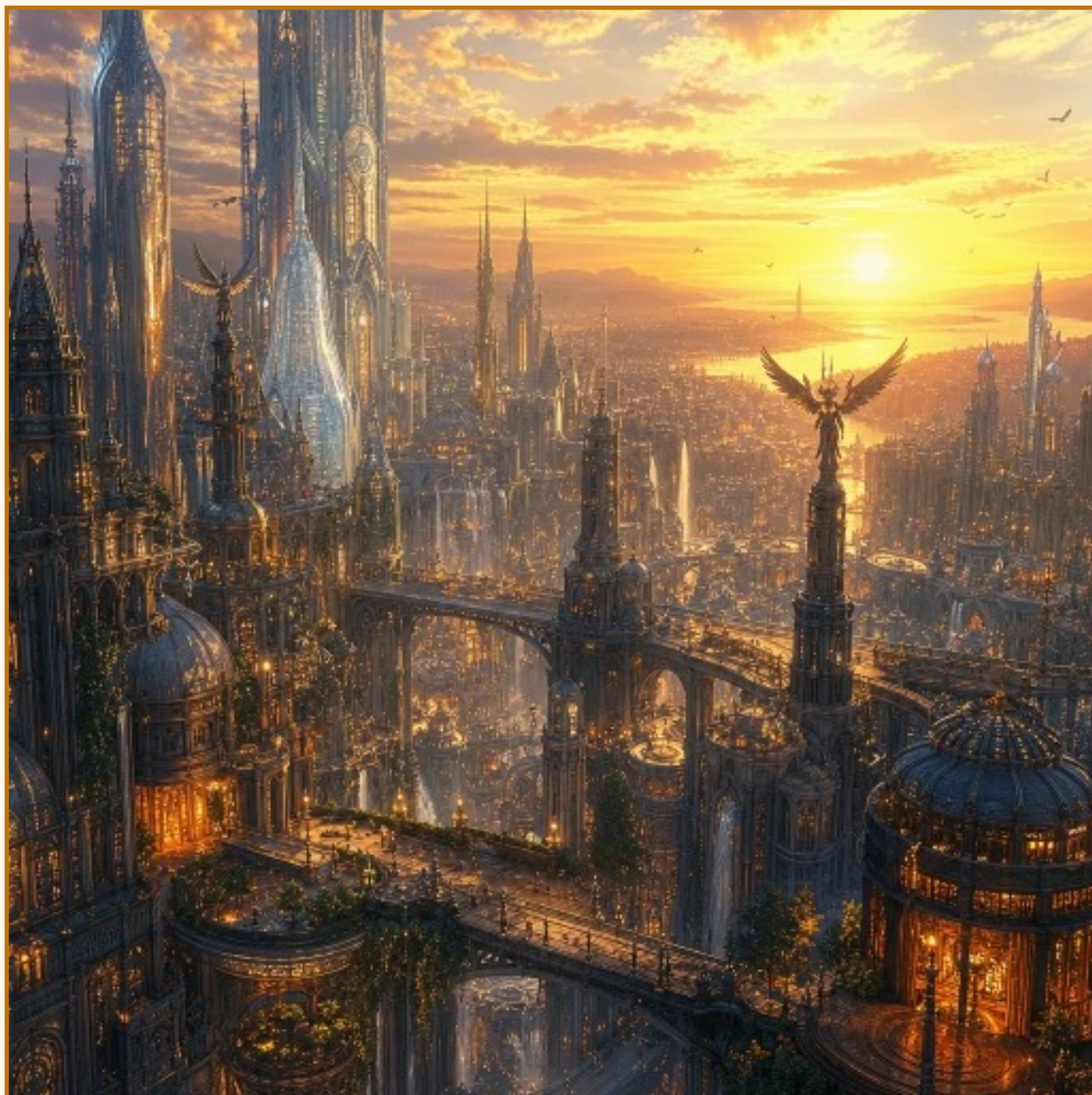
Tireless Hunter. The Bone Hound doesn't need to eat, drink, breathe, or sleep, and never suffers the effects of exhaustion from prolonged pursuit.

ACTIONS

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 11 (2d6 + 4) piercing damage plus 4 (1d8) necrotic damage.

THE FIFTEEN EMPIRES

Beginning with the First: The Shining Everlast



THE SHINING EVERLAST

The largest, most powerful empire in Mirrorbloom — a single continuous sprawl of towers reaching for a sky they can never quite touch.

THE SHINING EVERLAST

Patron: The Great Hope

Overview

The Shining Everlast is not a city with surrounding farmland and villages; it is, in its entirety, one unbroken urban mass, home to some fifty million people across ten major species and hundreds of minor ones. Its towers, some rivaling the tallest structures any mortal civilization has ever raised, are not merely architecture — they are the empire's central act of faith, a literal, physical reaching toward the Great Hope's domain, built by a people who have never stopped believing that if they build high enough, something up there might notice.

The empire runs on Hopelight: magic drawn from a dense convergence of ley lines beneath the city, refined into crystal that powers everything from streetlamps to the vast transit lifts connecting the city's vertical tiers, and present in lesser form as a baseline magical aptitude nearly every citizen carries from birth. For generations this system has made the Shining Everlast the wealthiest, most technologically dazzling empire in Mirrorbloom — and for the first time in living memory, it is beginning to fail. Hopelight crystal forms slowly, fed by genuine, sustained collective hope, and the city's hunger for expansion has begun to outpace what new hope the population can generate. The Senate, representative body of the empire's major species, has spent three years failing to agree on what to do about it.

Government

The Shining Everlast is governed by a Senate, with seats allocated proportionally by species rather than geography. Five major factions currently dominate the chamber, each holding a fundamentally different theory of how to address the Hopelight crisis, and none commanding anything close to a working majority. The Senate is presided over by a Speaker, elected to chair rather than vote, theoretically standing above factional politics.

GEOGRAPHY — THE SHINING EVERLAST

Eight vertical zones, lowest to highest.

THE UNDERLEVELS

Below street level

Canals, water systems, old foundations, and the deepest Hopelight conduit infrastructure run through here, predominantly tended by Tidewalkers. The least glamorous tier and the most essential — the rest of the city would stop running within days without it. The Underlevels feel the Hopelight shortage last, since infrastructure receives rationing priority, but would be hit hardest of all tiers if the system ever truly failed.

THE GROUND BAZAAR

Street level

Dense, chaotic, multi-species marketplaces and transit hubs, where Rabbitfolk courier networks crisscross a working-class population drawn from every major species and dozens of minor ones. This is the city's most visibly cosmopolitan tier, and the one that feels day-to-day Hopelight rationing most directly — dimming lamps, slowed transit lifts, the small daily inconveniences of a system running short.

THE FOUNDRY TIERS

Lower-mid towers

Emberforged and Orc engineering guild territory: manufacturing floors, Hopelight refineries, and the structural heart of the city's construction trade. Industrial, loud, and lit by working forges even when the rest of the city dims. The Deepwright faction's political power is strongest here, among workers proud of their craft and increasingly anxious about what they're being asked to dig for.

THE GREENBELT SPIRES

Mid towers

Rootkin-tended vertical gardens and residential terraces, surprisingly quiet and lush for a tier hundreds of stories up. Genuine parks, orchards, and tended green space wind through this level, maintained with the patient, generational care Rootkin culture is known for. The Verdant Accord's stronghold, and the site of the city's most beloved public festivals.

THE LAMPLIGHT QUARTER

Mid-upper towers

Mixed residential and commercial space where most of the city's multi-species middle class actually lives. Duskborn-run nightlife and after-hours trade dominate once the sun goes down, and the district stays genuinely alive around the clock. A natural home base for visitors who need a foothold in the city without the extremes of the Underlevels or the Crownspires.

THE GLASS COURTS

Upper towers

Senate chambers, judiciary, and the Glasswright community's heart, architecturally the most overtly magical-looking tier in the city — translucent walkways, light-refracting halls, and the chamber where Speaker Hale and the five senators conduct (or fail to conduct) the empire's business.

THE STORMREACH

Highest inhabited towers

Stormling territory and the domain of the city's highest-altitude tower maintenance crews, alongside the wealthiest non-institutional residential spires below the very top. Genuinely dangerous to live in if a tower destabilizes — height carries real risk here, a fact the Stormreach's wealthy residents mostly choose not to think about.

THE CROWNSPIRES

The literal tower-tops

The oldest elf-built towers' peaks alongside the newest ultra-luxury construction, smallest in population by far and closest, both symbolically and literally, to the Great Hope's domain. Minor, mostly unconfirmed shrine-doors to the Unclouded are rumored to exist somewhere up here, tended by a small and very private community of true believers.

HUMANS

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

As varied as any human population anywhere in Mirrorbloom — no single build, skin tone, or feature set dominates. What marks an Everlast-born human, more than anything physical, is posture: a habit of looking up, toward the towers, that visitors from other empires find distinctive within a generation or two of settling here.

Culture

Humans are the demographic backbone of the Shining Everlast, overrepresented in the senate simply by raw numbers, and culturally the empire's great improvisers — human guilds, human neighborhoods, and human-run businesses exist at every altitude, in every district, with no single unifying 'human culture' beyond a citywide reputation for adaptability bordering on restlessness. A human in the Underlevels and a human in the Crownspires often have less in common with each other than either does with their non-human neighbors.

Role in the City

Everywhere. Senate seats, guild leadership, street vendors, tower engineers — humans fill every economic and social niche the city offers, which is precisely the point; they're the empire's connective tissue.

A Notable Quirk

Human Everlast natives have a well-known superstition: counting the floors of a tower you're entering is supposed to be bad luck, a habit borrowed unconsciously from a culture that has learned, over generations, not to think too hard about how far up or down anything really goes.

ELVES

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Tall, long-limbed, and unmistakably patient in their movements — Everlast elves favor severe, architectural fashion that echoes the towers themselves, sharp vertical lines and minimal ornamentation. Many carry faint, old burn-scars from the early, less stable days of Hopelight refinement, worn without embarrassment as a mark of lineage.

Culture

The city's old money, in the most literal sense — several of the oldest standing towers were elf-built, predating the current senate system entirely, and elven families often hold generational seats and generational grudges in equal measure. Elven culture prizes long-term thinking, which makes them natural allies of the Verdant Accord even when they don't formally caucus with it.

Role in the City

Architecture, old-guard senate seats, long-horizon magical research — elves are disproportionately represented wherever patience is the actual asset being sold.

A Notable Quirk

It's considered deeply rude, among elves specifically, to ask how old a tower's foundation is. The honest answer is frequently 'older than your family's presence in this city,' and everyone involved generally prefers not to have that conversation out loud.

ORCS

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Powerfully built, with the practical calluses and burn-resistant skin of generations spent in close proximity to forges and load-bearing stonework. Orc fashion in the Everlast favors functional reinforced clothing over decoration — though guild colors and clan-markings are worn proudly, often dyed directly into work leathers.

Culture

Far from any savage-coded stereotype, Everlast orcs built the city's structural engineering guilds from the ground up and remain the backbone of its tower-construction trade, prized equally for raw strength and exacting precision. Orc culture runs on guild loyalty, apprenticeship lineages, and a deep, almost religious respect for buildings that don't fall down.

Role in the City

Structural engineering, construction guilds, heavy industry — the literal builders of the skyline, including the Foundry Tiers' backbone workforce.

A Notable Quirk

An orc engineering guild's worst insult isn't aimed at a person at all — it's calling someone's work 'a Last Shine job,' implying shoddy construction that looks fine until it doesn't. Most orcs who use the phrase have no idea how literally true it is.

RABBITFOLK

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Small, quick, long-eared humanoids with an enormous range of fur coloration and pattern — no two rabbitfolk families look quite alike, which they consider a point of pride rather than oddity. Built for speed and tight spaces, equally at home darting through Ground Bazaar crowds or scrambling along tower exterior maintenance lines.

Culture

Organized around enormous, sprawling extended-family clans rather than nuclear households; a rabbitfolk child might have functional aunts, uncles, and cousins numbering in the dozens, most of them not blood relations at all but clan-adopted. This structure maps neatly onto their dominance of the city's courier and transit networks — moving information and goods quickly is, culturally, what family is for.

Role in the City

Courier networks, transit systems, message-running between districts and altitudes — if something needs to move fast across the Shining Everlast, a rabbitfolk clan is usually involved.

A Notable Quirk

Rabbitfolk clans maintain an informal but fiercely enforced rule: a courier message, once accepted, must be delivered even if the sender changes their mind. Several minor city scandals have started this way.

GLASSWRIGHTS

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Humanoids with translucent, faintly luminous skin that shifts subtly with genuine emotion — most noticeably, traces of actual Hopelight glow through when a Glasswright feels real joy, a trait no amount of practice fully suppresses.

Culture

Famously, almost comically bad liars, which has pushed Glasswright culture toward radical, sometimes uncomfortable honesty as a matter of necessity rather than virtue. Overrepresented in diplomacy and the judiciary precisely because of this — a Glasswright advocate can't credibly misrepresent the facts, which courts and treaty negotiations alike have learned to rely on.

Role in the City

Diplomacy, judiciary, public records — anywhere institutional trust matters more than persuasive flexibility. The Glasswright Compact's entire platform stems directly from this cultural trait.

A Notable Quirk

Glasswright poker is, unsurprisingly, not a popular pastime among Glasswrights themselves. It's a beloved pastime among everyone else, played specifically against Glasswrights, who almost universally lose and almost universally keep playing anyway.

STORMLINGS

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Winged humanoids descended from creatures who once lived among the high clouds the towers now physically pierce; feathered or membrane-winged depending on lineage, with keen distance vision and a restless, wind-tested look about them even indoors.

Culture

A culture of motion — Stormlings traditionally distrust prolonged stillness, and many young Stormlings undertake a coming-of-age flight circuit of the entire city's highest spires before settling into any trade. This restlessness fuels both their dominance of high-altitude tower maintenance and their outsized presence in the Stormcall Expansionists' ranks.

Role in the City

Tower maintenance at extreme height, message-running between the Stormreach and Crownspires, scouting and exploration — the empire's literal eyes on the horizon.

A Notable Quirk

A Stormling who has never left the city is considered, gently but unmistakably, a little unwell by their own community — not shamed exactly, but quietly worried over, the way other cultures might worry about someone who never leaves their house.

ROOTKIN

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Plant-adjacent humanoids with bark-textured or leaf-flecked skin, growing visibly slower than most other species — a Rootkin in their first century of life might still be physically maturing, a fact that shapes nearly everything about how their families function.

Culture

Deeply, generationally rooted — quite literally, in many cases, with family land passed down and tended rather than sold, even amid a city where vertical real estate is the empire's most valuable commodity. Rootkin patience is legendary and occasionally maddening to other species; they think in centuries by default, which makes them natural anchors of the Verdant Accord.

Role in the City

Tower gardens, the city's few true green spaces, slow-cultivation magic — almost the entirety of the Greenbelt Spires' upkeep runs through Rootkin hands.

A Notable Quirk

It's considered a genuine, serious compliment among Rootkin to be told you've 'grown well' — and a genuine, serious insult to be told you've grown fast. Rootkin children who mature unusually quickly sometimes face quiet social difficulty over it.

EMBERFORGED

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Humanoids with warm, stone-and-metal-flecked skin that genuinely radiates low heat, born near (by tradition, if not always literal fact) the city's old forges. Their skin often carries faint mineral seams that catch the light, especially Hopelight, in ways other species' skin doesn't.

Culture

Artisan and engineering culture above all else — Emberforged families trace lineage through what they've built and refined rather than blood alone, and a family's standing is measured in the durability of its work. This drives both their dominance of Hopelight crystal refinement and their strong representation in the Deepwrights.

Role in the City

Artisans, engineers, Hopelight infrastructure — much of the actual refinement process that turns raw crystal into usable power runs through Emberforged hands and workshops.

A Notable Quirk

An Emberforged will often introduce themselves by trade before name — 'I'm a lampwright, Senna's my name' rather than the reverse — a habit other species find backward until they understand how central craft-identity actually is.

TIDEWALKERS

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Amphibious humanoids with smooth, faintly damp-looking skin and webbed extremities, equally capable below the city's canals and on its streets, though most prefer the Underlevels' humidity to the drier air above.

Culture

Practical, infrastructure-minded, and quietly proud of work that almost no one above street level ever thinks about — a city of fifty million people needs serious water and waste systems, and Tidewalker culture has built its entire identity around being indispensable rather than visible. This grounded pragmatism feeds directly into the Ration Compact's cautious, infrastructure-first politics.

Role in the City

Underlevel infrastructure, water systems, canal transit — the unglamorous, essential machinery that keeps the rest of the city's glamour running.

A Notable Quirk

Tidewalkers have a saying, blunt enough that other species find it almost funny: 'The towers are for looking at. The canals are for living.' It is not entirely a joke.

DUSKBORN

Major species of THE SHINING EVERLAST

Appearance

Pale, quiet humanoids who are visibly more comfortable and alert after dark, with large, light-sensitive eyes and a calm, unhurried way of moving through crowds even at the city's busiest hours.

Culture

An entire shadow-economy of nightlife, after-hours trade, and quiet service runs through Duskborn hands, and Duskborn culture has built genuine pride around the hours other species sleep through. They are sometimes side-eyed by day-dwelling neighbors for no real reason beyond unfamiliarity — a casual, mostly unexamined prejudice that Duskborn community leaders have been pushing back against for generations.

Role in the City

After-hours economy, night markets, the Lamplight Quarter's entertainment district — anything the city needs running while most of it sleeps.

A Notable Quirk

Duskborn families mark a child's coming-of-age not with a birthday but with their first full night spent entirely awake and alone — a tradition day-dwelling neighbors frequently misunderstand as troubling, much to ongoing Duskborn exasperation.

THE SENATE

THE SHINING EVERLAST

TORAVIN HALE

Speaker of the Senate — Human
Neutral Chair

Stance

Presides over the senate without a vote, theoretically above the five factions' infighting. In practice, decades in the chair have taught him exactly how to use procedure as leverage — which motions get tabled, whose petitions get fast-tracked, which crises get an emergency session and which quietly wait their turn.

Personality

Scrupulously, visibly fair. Tired in the specific way of someone who has spent a long career being trusted by people who don't fully trust each other. Speaks in careful, measured sentences even in private.

Secret

He has read every faction's private numbers, and by his own count, the Ration Compact's worst-case timeline is optimistic. He has not told anyone this. His real, unspoken position is that the senate itself may not survive making this decision in time — that his actual job, the one nobody elected him to, might be managing how the Shining Everlast fails, rather than preventing it.

Adventure Hook

A party that earns Toravin's trust may be the only people he'd ever consider telling the truth to — and the only ones positioned to act on it without triggering the senate's collective panic.

VOSS KAEEL

Speaker-Senator — Emberforged

The Deepwrights

Stance

Believes the Hopelight crisis is a supply problem with a supply solution: dig further into the ley convergence, accept the structural risk, push past old safety boundaries. Heavily backed by Emberforged and Orc engineering guilds who profit from expanded mining contracts.

Personality

Blunt, impatient, genuinely believes the other factions are gambling with the city's future by doing nothing. Talks fast, interrupts often, softens noticeably around his own guild's apprentices.

Secret

Privately terrified he's wrong — that the deeper veins his guild wants to tap are deeper for a reason. He has quietly suppressed at least one engineer's report suggesting exactly that.

Adventure Hook

The suppressed report still exists, filed somewhere it shouldn't be. Whoever finds it holds real leverage over the most powerful faction in the senate.

ILYENNE WOVENBARK

First-Root Senator — Rootkin

The Verdant Accord

Stance

Argues the crisis isn't about mining, it's about cultivating genuine civic joy and purpose at scale — festivals, public works, reducing despair-driving poverty — since Hopelight crystal forms from sustained collective hope.

Personality

Centuries-patient, maddeningly calm in session, genuinely beloved by ordinary citizens for the public garden-festivals her faction has sponsored.

Secret

Her theory about hope and crystal growth isn't wrong — it's her timescale that's the problem. She thinks in generations; the city is dying in years. She has not fully reckoned with that gap herself.

Adventure Hook

A party that can show Ilyenne hard evidence of the actual timeline might be the only ones capable of shaking her glacial patience into something resembling urgency — for better or worse.

CORIS BRASK

Senator-Marshal — Tidewalker
The Ration Compact

Stance

The cautious middle: freeze new tower construction, ration Hopelight to essential infrastructure, buy time rather than gamble on a fix. Popular with working-class districts who'd bear the brunt of either a mining collapse or an economic boom-bust.

Personality

Pragmatic, exhausted, quietly resents being cast as the boring villain of every faction's narrative. Former infrastructure administrator, not a career politician.

Secret

Keeps a private ledger of exactly how many days of Hopelight reserve remain — a number none of the other senators want to hear out loud, and one Coris has started to suspect is worse than even she's let on publicly.

Adventure Hook

Coris's private ledger is the single most accurate piece of intelligence in the entire senate. She'd share it with outsiders before she'd share it with most of her colleagues.

THESS AURELIN

Windcaller Senator — Stormling
The Stormcall Expansionists

Stance

Wants to send expeditions beyond the Shining Everlast's borders to locate and claim new ley convergence points elsewhere in Mirrorbloom, founding new tower-colonies.

Personality

Young, magnetic, genuinely believes expansion is the bold solution the city needs. Charismatic in session, restless outside it.

Secret

Doesn't fully recognize (or won't admit) how badly her plan could mirror old-world colonialism if executed carelessly. Has already sent one scouting expedition beyond the empire's borders without full senate authorization. It hasn't reported back.

Adventure Hook

Finding out what happened to the missing expedition — and what or who they actually encountered out there — is an open adventure hook with real stakes for the whole senate.

MIRA GLASSWRIGHT

Senator — Glasswright
The Glasswright Compact

Stance

Pushes for radical public transparency about how dire the crisis actually is, rather than the senate's habit of quiet reassurance. Doesn't have a fix — believes the gridlock is partly caused by nobody being honest about how bad things have gotten.

Personality

Quiet, precise, visibly incapable of spin — her skin dims with telltale grey when she's being less than fully honest, a tell the other senators have learned to watch for.

Secret

The only senator who has said outright, on record, that the city may not have a solution at all, only choices about how to fail — a position that makes her simultaneously the least powerful and most trusted person in the chamber.

Adventure Hook

Mira physically cannot lie to a party that asks her a direct question. She's an extremely efficient source of ground truth, if anyone bothers to ask her the right questions.



THE LAST SHINE

The corrupted mirror of the Shining Everlast — towers that were built to reach the sky, now sinking slowly back into the dark.

PRELLA ASHCOURT

Tier-Warden — Elf
The Starvation Guild

Stance

Believes Hollowlight should be hoarded by the upper towers and old families, rationing the underlevels into literal darkness. Frames this openly as deserved hierarchy rather than necessity.

Personality

Aristocratic, unbothered, genuinely doesn't see the lower tiers' suffering as her problem to solve. Polished and well-spoken in a way that makes her cruelty sound reasonable in the room.

Secret

Was, generations ago, born in the Last Shine's own equivalent of the Underlevels. Has spent her entire life since making sure no one remembers that, including, increasingly, herself.

Adventure Hook

Proof of Prella's origins, if surfaced publicly, would devastate her standing with the old families she's spent a lifetime impressing — and might, just possibly, crack something open in her that she's buried for decades.

GRAEL VESS

Senator — Glasswright (mirrors Mira Glasswright)

The Last Honest Voice

Stance

The one faction that isn't purely venal: a small, mostly powerless bloc who believe the Last Shine cannot be saved, and that the only moral act left is making the collapse as humane as possible.

Personality

Weary, gentle, carries none of the cruelty of his colleagues — and is treated by all of them as a sick joke precisely because of it. Shares his counterpart's inability to convincingly lie.

Secret

Privately still believes, against all evidence and against his own public position, that the Last Shine could be saved — he has simply stopped saying so out loud because no one has believed him in years.

Adventure Hook

Grael may be the only senator in the Last Shine an outside party can actually trust at face value — and possibly the only one who would genuinely welcome outside help, if he believed it was real.